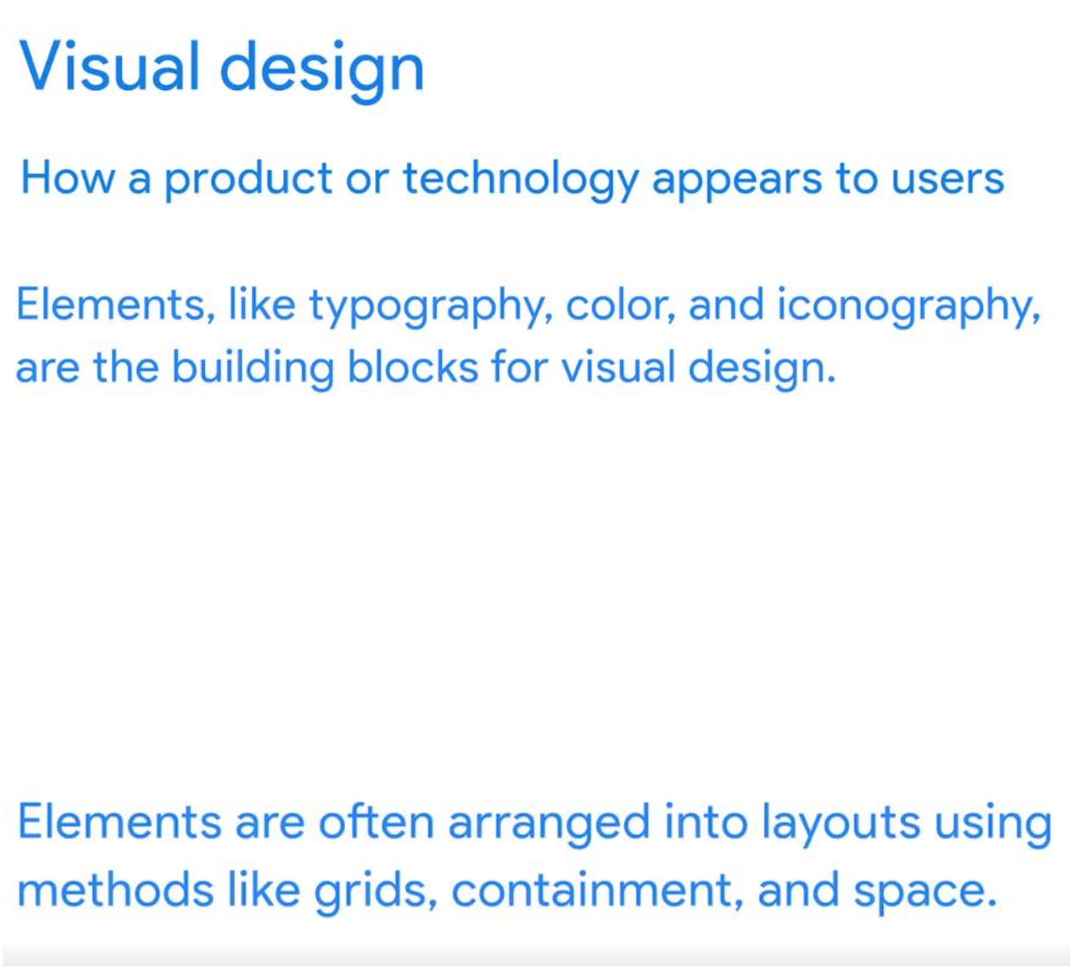
Fpt Education

Lesson07
Create High-Fidelity Designs and Prototypes in Figma

Visual design

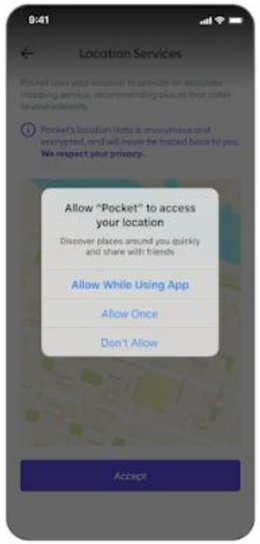
- We'll start to create a mockup, which is a high-fidelity design that represents your final product. To create mockups, we'll use visual design elements and layouts. Elements, like typography, color, and iconography, are the building blocks for visual design. Elements are often arranged into layouts using methods like grids, containment, and space.
- Visual design is a massive world, so at times it might seem overwhelming. Learning visual design elements and ways to arrange them doesn't happen overnight.



Mock Up



Main screen



Location access



City selection



Map theme

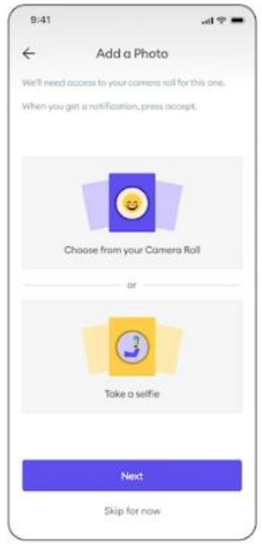
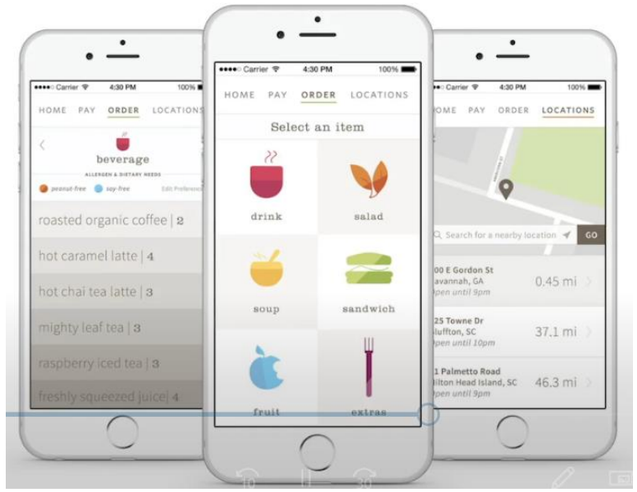


Photo upload



Fidelity

How closely a design matches the look and feel of the final product

Low fidelity (lo-fi)

A design that has a lower amount of complexity and is less refined or polished

High fidelity (hi-fi)

A design that closely matches the look and feel of the final product and is more refined or polished overall

Mockup

A static, high fidelity design that is used as a representation of a final product

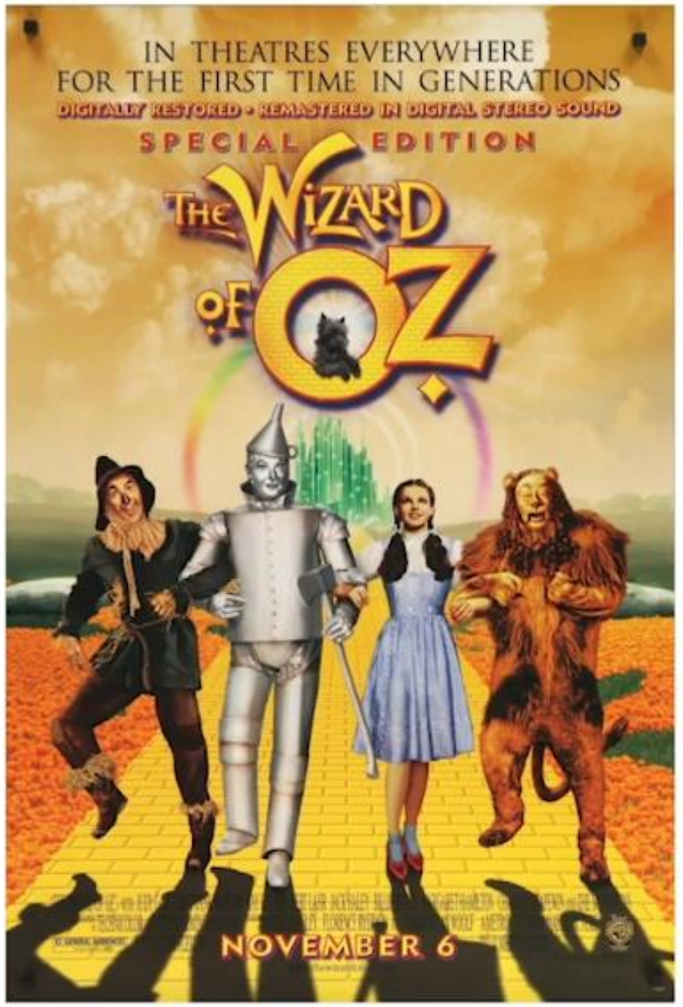
high-fidelity (hi-fi)

- Lo-fi designs are simpler and less refined, used for quickly iterating ideas and leaving room for exploration.
- In contrast, hi-fi designs are more polished, resembling the actual product to gather precise user feedback.
- The course emphasizes using mockups—a type of hi-fi design—to visually represent the final product and refine the user experience based on aesthetic elements like typography, color, and iconography.

Introduction to foundational elements of visual design

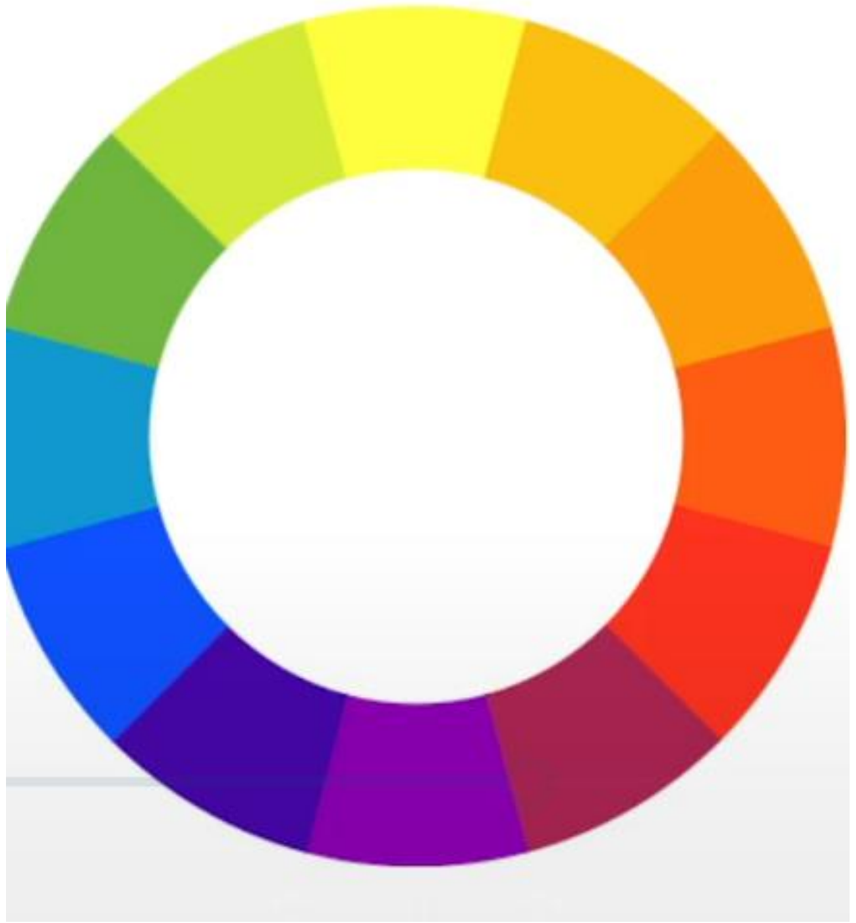
These elements are typography, color, and iconography, each playing a unique role in enhancing user experience.

1.Typography is about the selection and arrangement of type to make the text not only readable but also visually appealing and appropriate for its context. For instance, the choice of font on a movie poster, like "The Wizard of Oz," helps convey a sense of playfulness and sets the visual hierarchy of information.



Introduction to foundational elements of visual design

2.Color is used to communicate messages, evoke emotions, and establish visual appeal. A good understanding of the color wheel helps UX designers choose colors that complement each other and enhance the overall design coherence.



Introduction to foundational elements of visual design

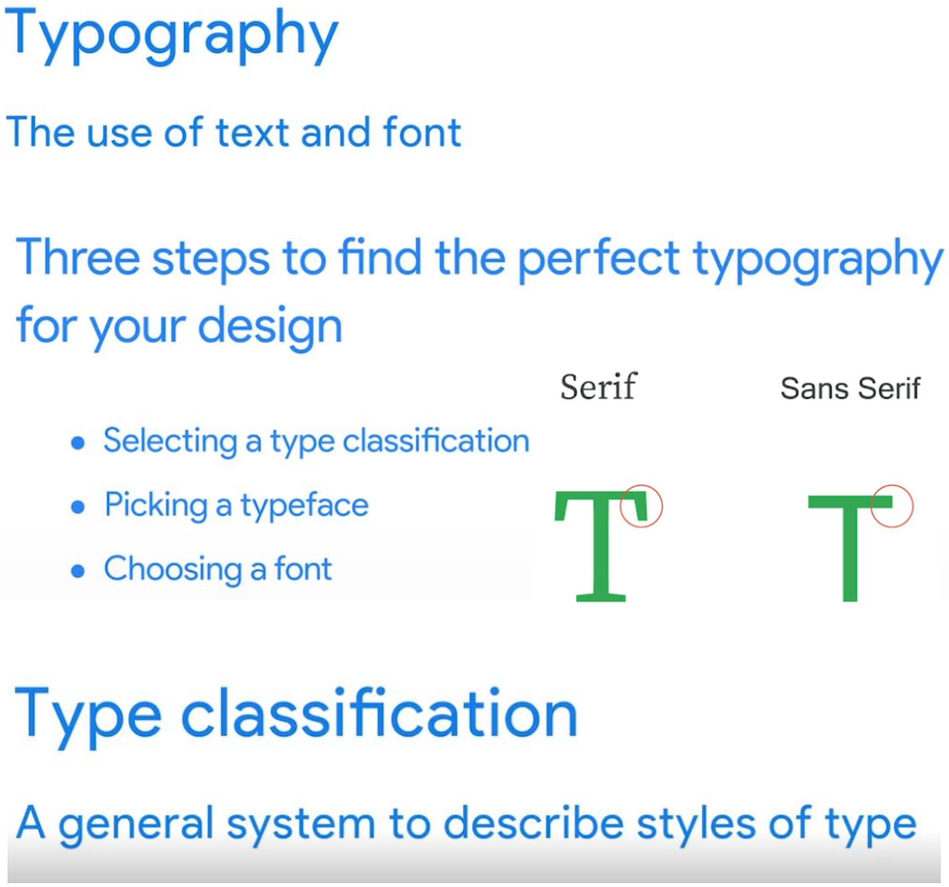
3.Iconography involves using symbols to represent concepts or actions, such as the power icon on electronic devices, which is universally recognizable.



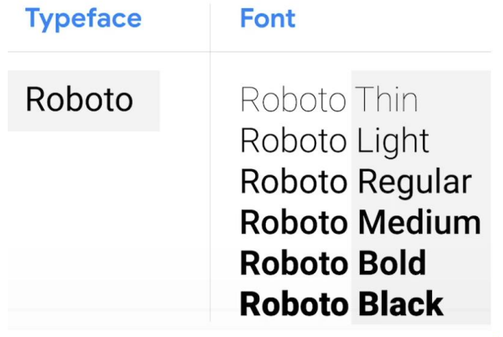
While these elements are vital, the course emphasizes that visual appeal should not overshadow usability. The primary role of a UX designer is to merge aesthetic considerations with user-friendly design practices. We will delve deeper into each element starting with typography in the upcoming videos, providing a comprehensive understanding necessary for creating effective and appealing mockups.

Typography in UX design

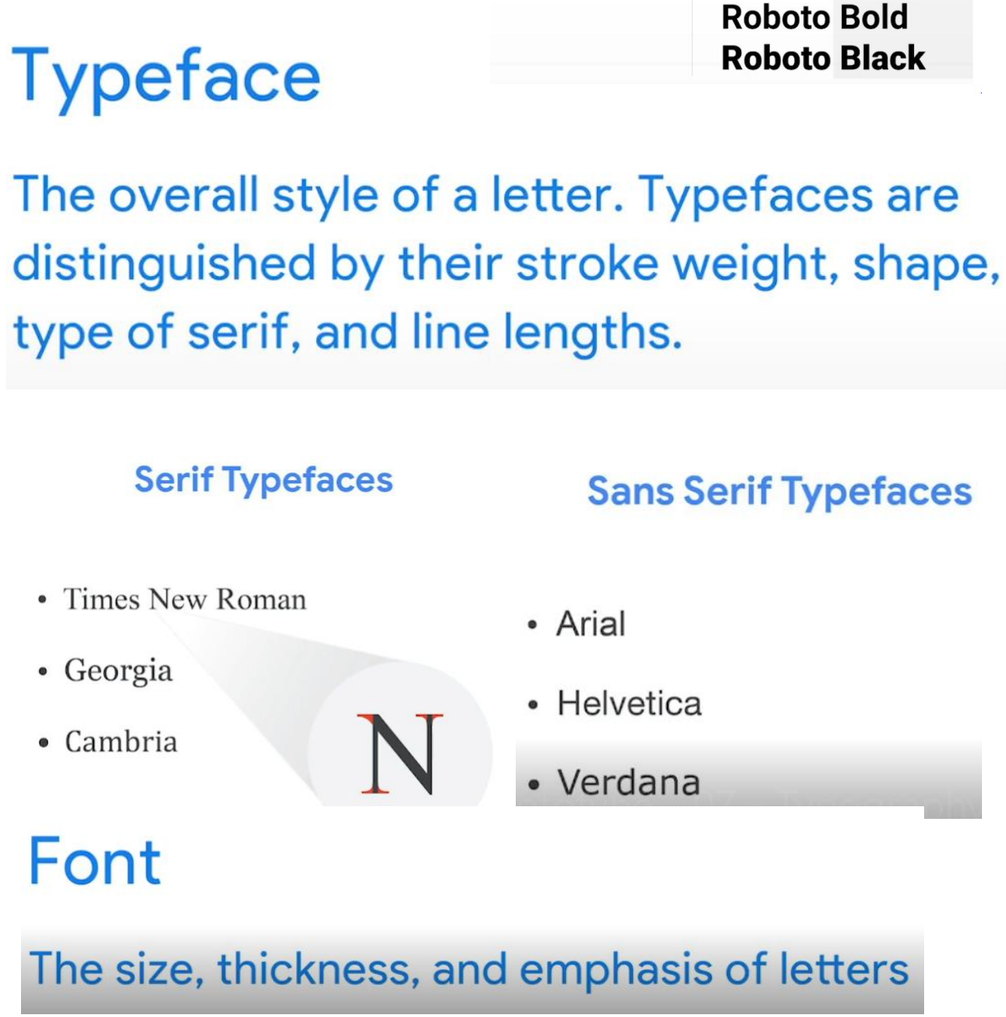
- Choosing the perfect typography into three steps: selecting a type classification, picking a typeface, and choosing a font.
- **Type Classification:** This refers to the broad categories that describe styles of type, primarily divided into Serif and Sans Serif. Serif typefaces, identifiable by the small lines at the ends of strokes, convey a traditional feel, whereas Sans Serif typefaces, lacking these lines, offer a cleaner, more modern look. The choice between these can significantly affect the mood and clarity of your design.



Typography in UX design



- **Typeface:** A typeface is essentially the design of the lettering, encompassing the weight, shape, and style of the characters. Familiar examples include Times New Roman and Georgia for Serif, and Arial and Helvetica for Sans Serif. With advancements in screen resolutions, Serif typefaces have regained popularity for digital content, offering more options for designers.
- **Font:** This is the specific style of a typeface, including variations in size, weight, and emphasis, like bold or italic. For instance, Roboto Bold in 12-point size is a font, distinct from Roboto Light in 18-point size, which is another font. Understanding this distinction is key to implementing typography effectively in your designs.



The importance of typography

1.Hierarchy:
Typography helps organize content by providing visual cues that indicate the importance of different pieces of text. This is done through variations in font size, weight, and style, aiding users in navigating the interface and absorbing information effectively.



Typography

- Adds hierarchy
- Makes text easy to read
- Matches brand guidelines

Typographic hierarchy

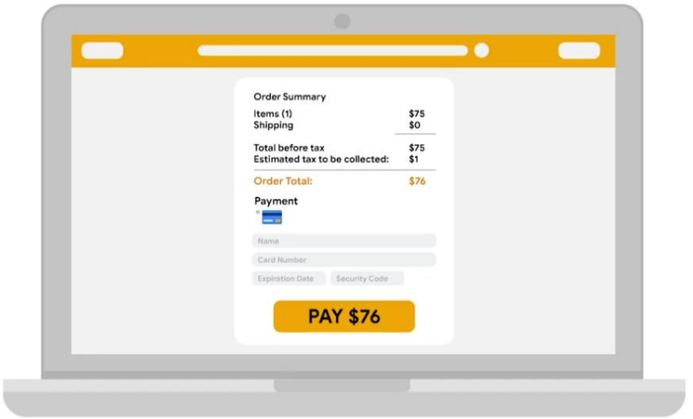
A method of ordering typefaces and fonts in a layout to create divisions that show users where to focus and how to find information



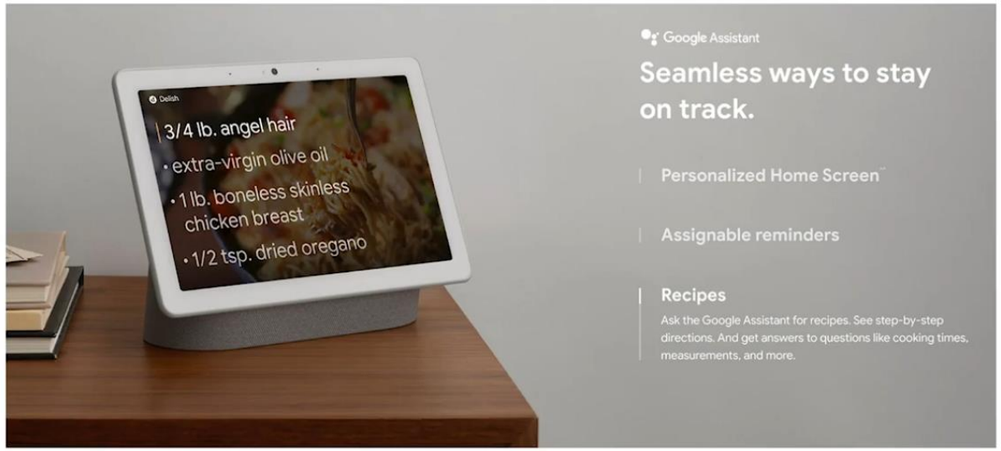
The importance of typography

2.Legibility: Ensuring text is easy to read is crucial, particularly for users with visual impairments. Effective typography enhances the readability of content, ensuring that all users can interact with the product comfortably.

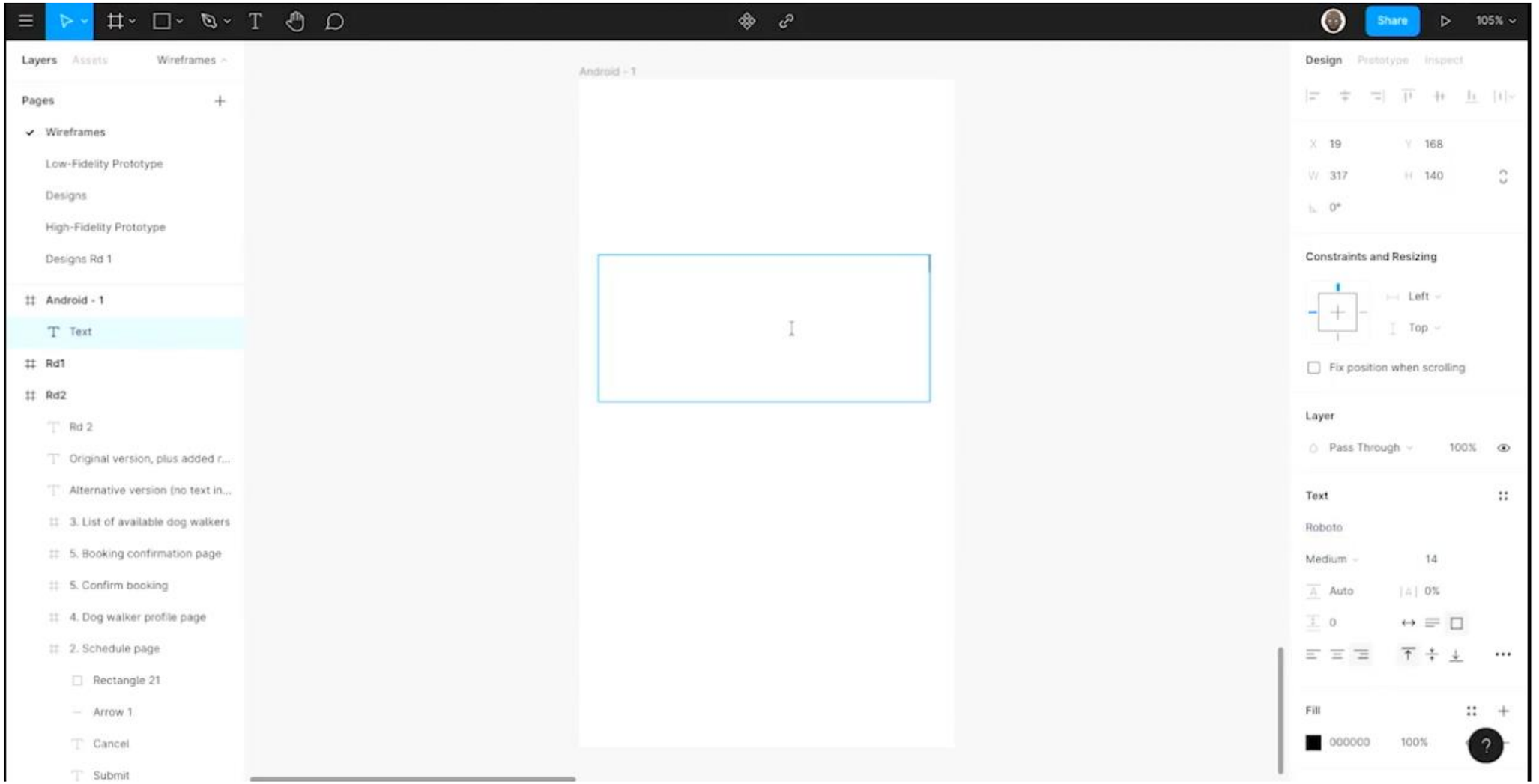
3.Brand Identity: Typography can also reflect and reinforce a brand's identity and values. Consistent use of specific typefaces and styles helps maintain uniformity across a brand's communications, making it recognizable and unique.



Google Sans



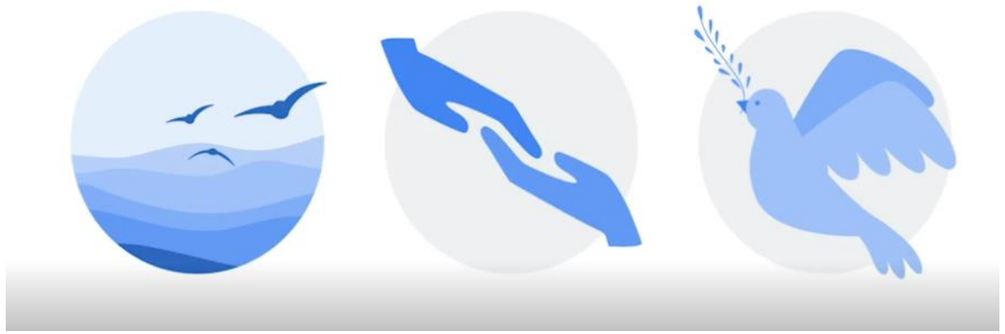
The importance of typography



Color in UX design

- Color is powerful—it can affect our mood, behavior, and even the actions we take. Understanding color and its implications in design is essential for creating effective and appealing visual communications.
- **Emotional Impact**: Colors have the ability to convey emotions and influence perception. For instance, red can attract attention and signal urgency, while blue can evoke calmness and trust.



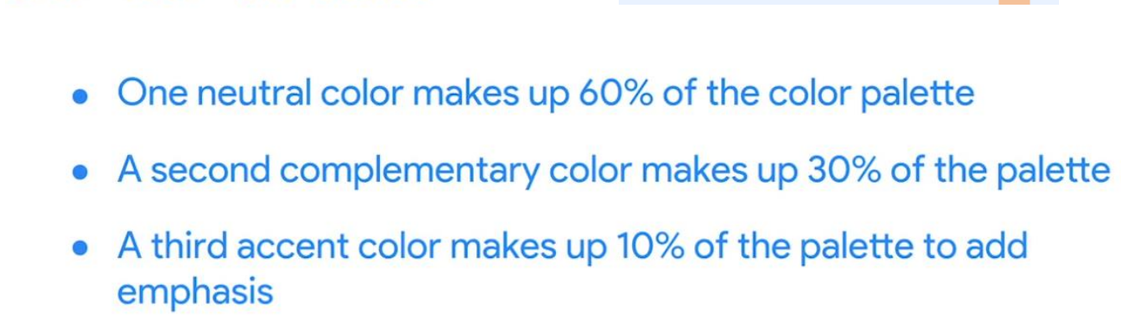


60-30-10 Rule

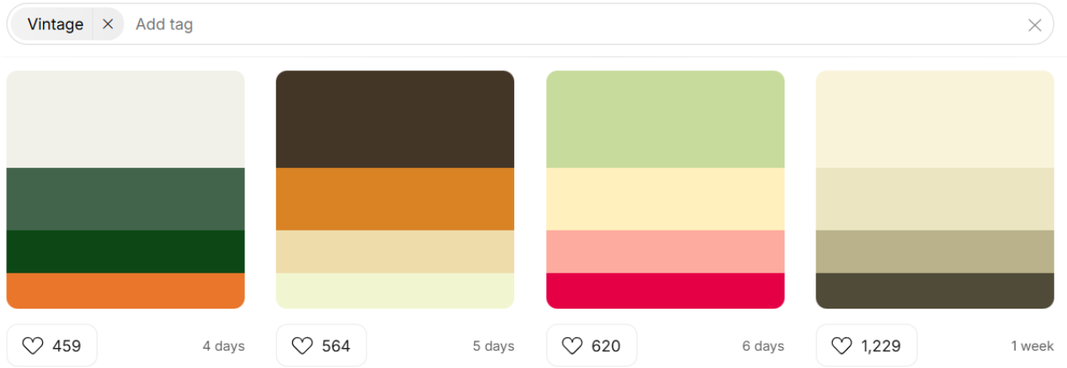


- **Visual Hierarchy**: Using colors strategically can help create a visual hierarchy, guiding users to important elements like buttons or calls to action. For example, a brightly colored button on a website can draw attention and encourage clicks.
- https://www.vwthemes.com/blogs/all/call-to-action-buttons

- **Cultural Significance**: Colors can have different meanings in different cultures, which is crucial to consider in global product design to ensure that the colors used do not convey unintended messages.

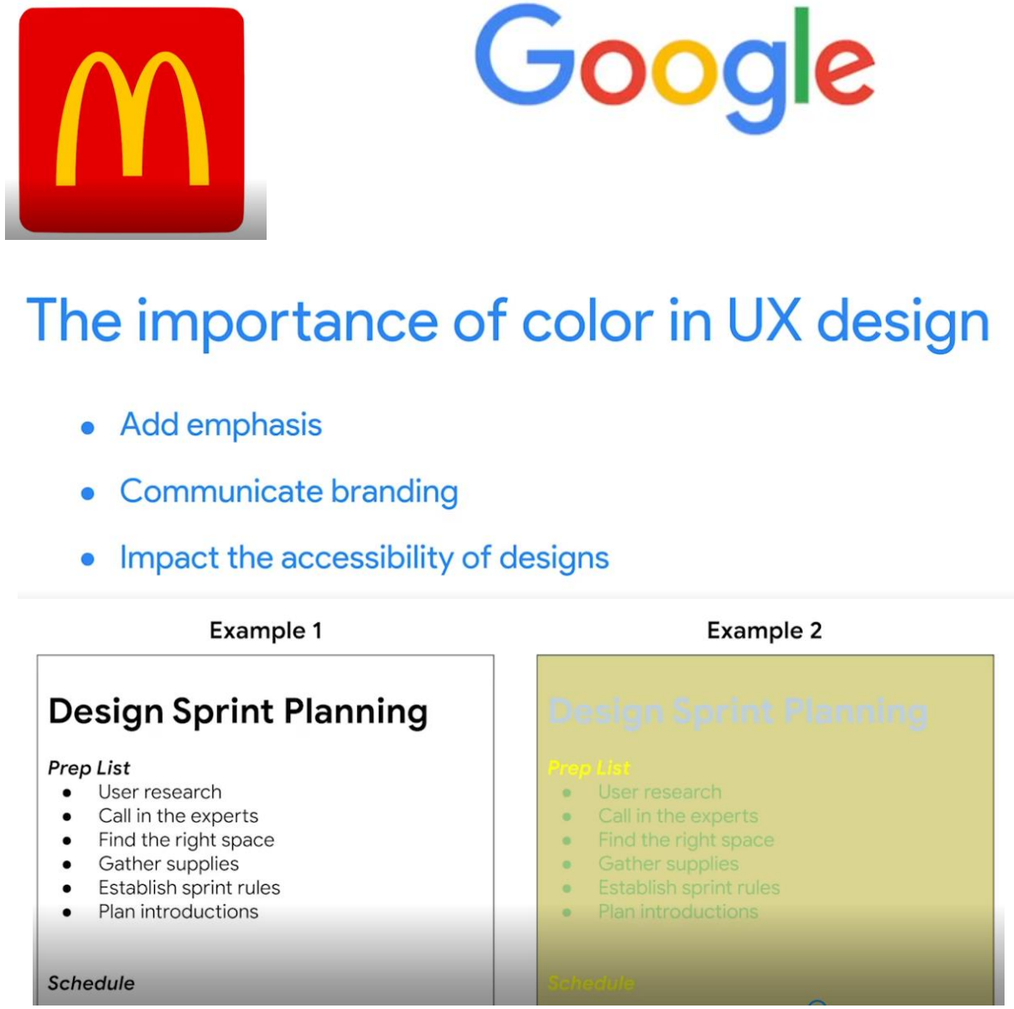


https://colorhunt.co/palettes/popular



Importance of Color in UX Design

- **Branding**: Color is a powerful tool for branding. Consistent use of specific colors can help reinforce brand identity and ensure that the product is recognizable.
- **Accessibility**: Proper use of color improves accessibility. High contrast between text and background colors, for example, makes content more readable for everyone, including those with visual impairments.

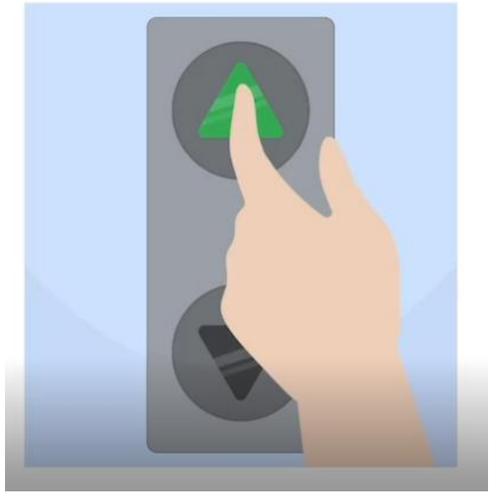


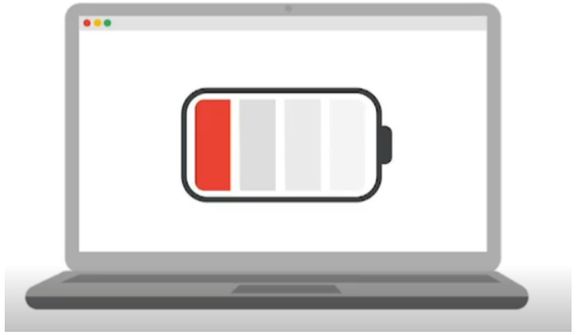
Iconography in UX design

- **What is Iconography?**
- Iconography uses symbols that make digital interfaces easier to navigate by saving space and helping users move through information or tasks more intuitively.
- For example: An upward or downward arrow on an elevator button indicates direction. A sun icon might be used to adjust brightness on a device.

Iconography

A system of graphic images or symbols that are associated with a subject or an idea



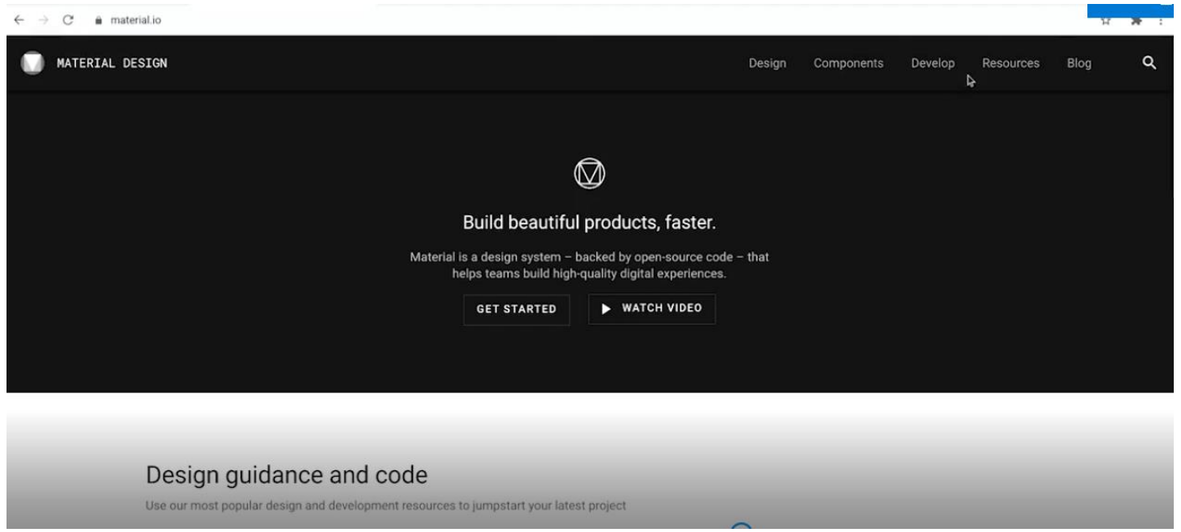




Purpose of Icons in UX Design

Icons are pivotal for:

- **Directing user actions:** Like navigating to a different page or executing specific functions.
- **Providing information:** Icons like a battery might indicate the need to recharge.
- **Enhancing usability and aesthetics:** Icons can make interfaces cleaner and more functional.
- **Universality and Cultural Considerations**
- Some icons are universally recognized (like a home icon for returning to a main menu).
- Others might need to be adapted for cultural relevance (e.g., using a soccer ball icon instead of an American football to represent sports globally).



Implementing Iconography in Design

•**Combine icons with text labels:** This practice enhances accessibility as screen readers can't interpret icons but can read text labels.
•**Consider the brand:** Icons should align with a company's brand style and colors.
•**Ensure clarity and familiarity:** Avoid overly complex icons that might confuse users.

Implementing Iconography in Design

We'll also demonstrate how to integrate an icon into a project using Figma and other design tools, focusing on ensuring that these icons are both functional and stylistically aligned with the overall design and brand guidelines.

By mastering the use of iconography, you can significantly enhance the user experience, making your digital products more intuitive and accessible. Let's dive in and explore how to effectively implement these visual elements in your designs.

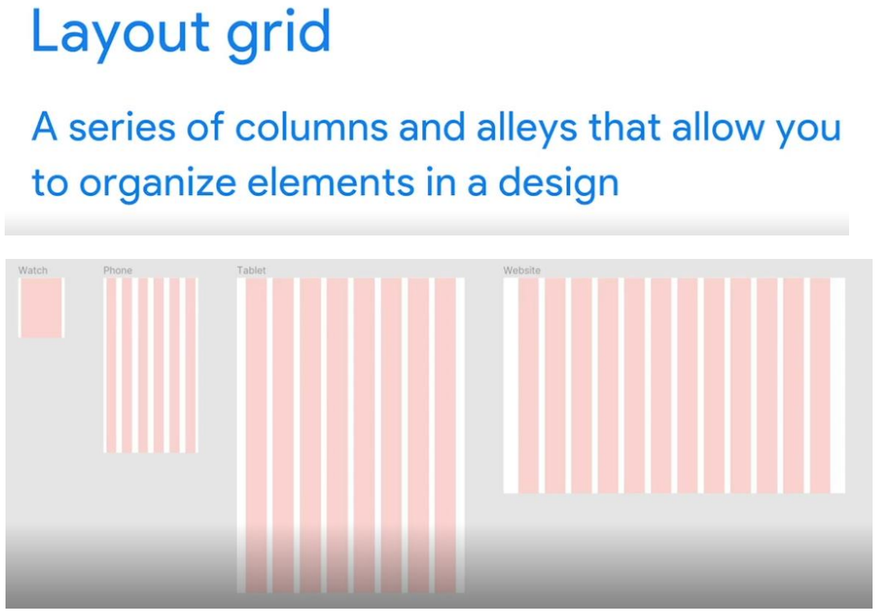






Understanding Layouts

- **Purpose of Layouts:** Layouts help organize the design elements in a visually appealing and functional manner, ensuring the design is user-friendly and effective.
- **Components of Layouts:** These include the placement of text, icons, images, and style elements.
- **Impact of Layouts:** Without well-thought-out layouts, your design may become challenging to navigate and interact with, leading to a poor user experience.



Common Layouts in UX Design

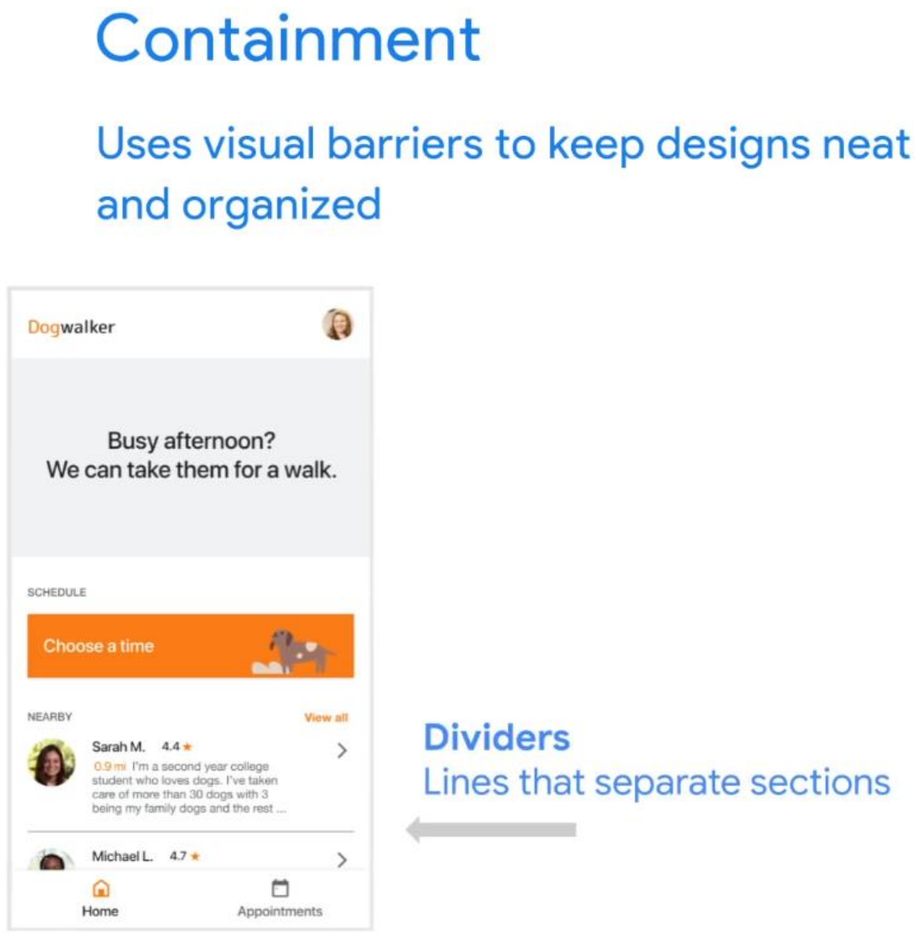
- Layouts are often reused across similar projects due to their proven effectiveness in particular contexts.
- Examples include layouts for home screens, login screens, and checkout screens, each tailored to optimize user interactions on those specific pages.



Exploring Methods of Containment

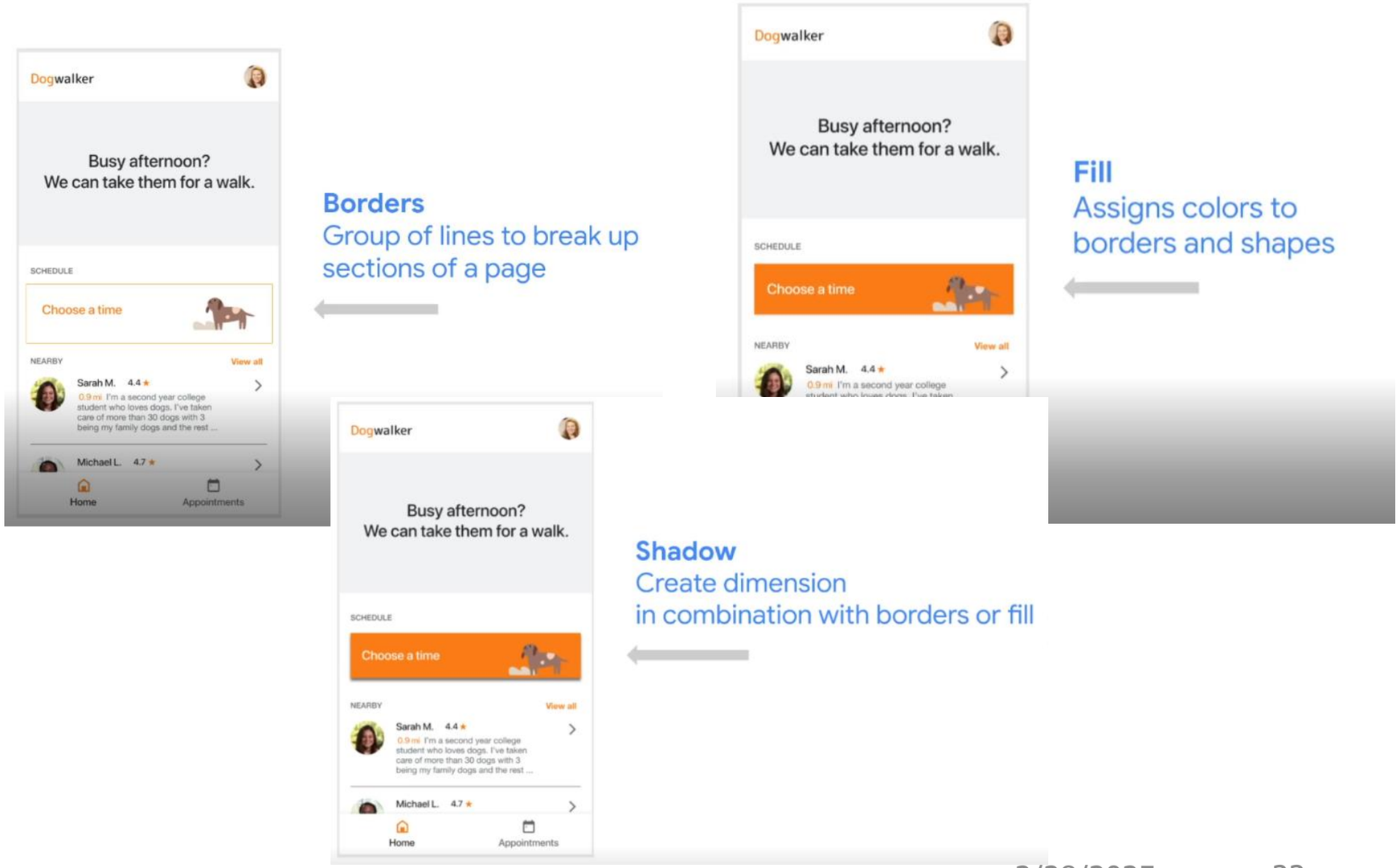
Containment is all about using visual barriers to create neat, organized designs. These barriers, like lines or colors, confine content to specific sections, making your design look cleaner and more structured.

- **Dividers**: These are lines that help separate different sections of content. In the dog walker app, for example, gray dividers are used between each listed dog walker to visually separate them.



Exploring Methods of Containment

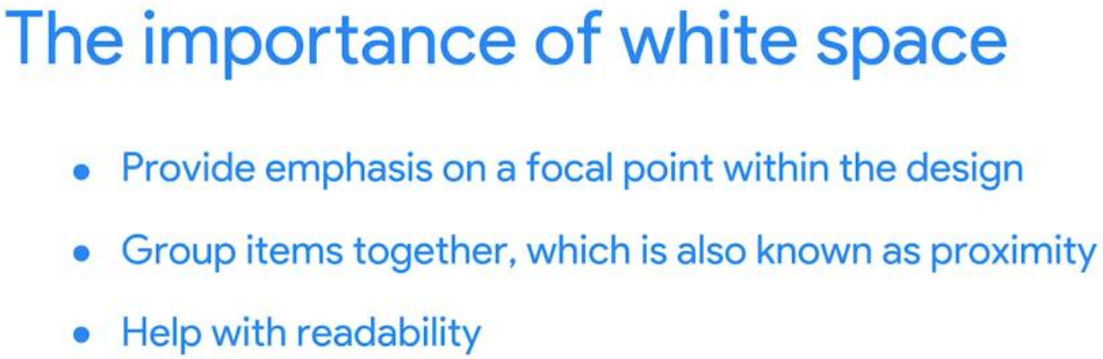
- **Borders**: Borders are continuous lines that enclose content, often forming shapes like rectangles or squares. Adding a rectangular border around a button, for instance, can make it clearly identifiable as clickable.
- **Fill**: This involves coloring inside borders or shapes to highlight or emphasize elements. For instance, adding an orange fill to the 'choose-a-time' button makes it stand out more prominently.
- **Shadow**: Adding shadows can give depth to your design, making elements like buttons pop out as if they are three-dimensional.

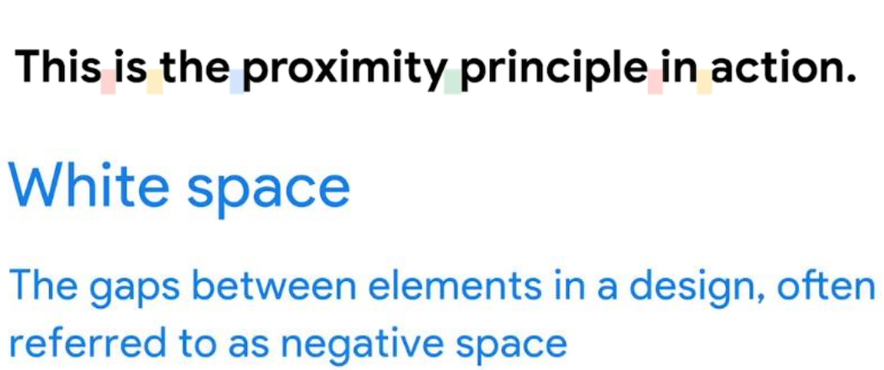


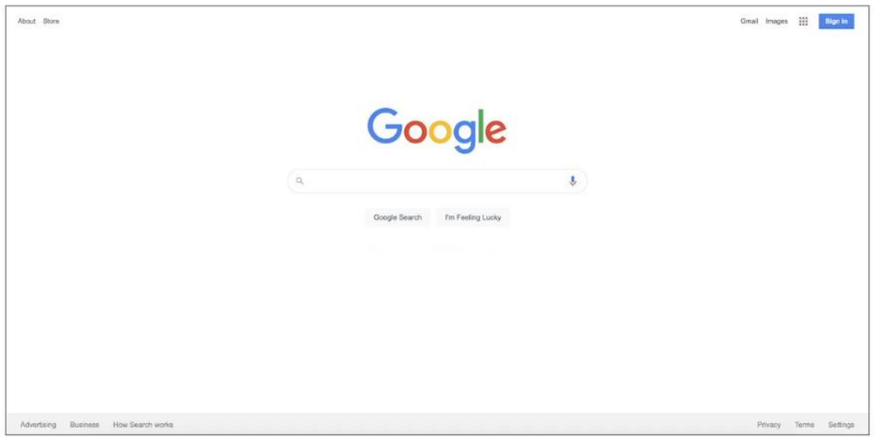
White Space

Spacing, or white space, refers to the gaps between design elements. It's crucial for creating a user-friendly interface because it emphasizes important elements, groups related items, and enhances readability.

- **Why is White Space Important?**
- **Emphasis**: White space can draw attention to key elements, such as a sign-up button or a specific call to action, making it clear what users should focus on next.

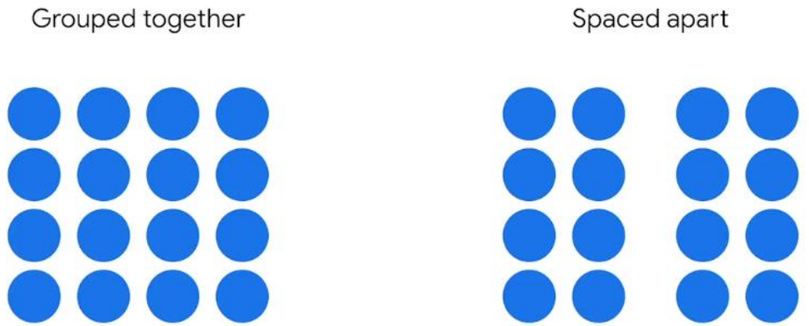


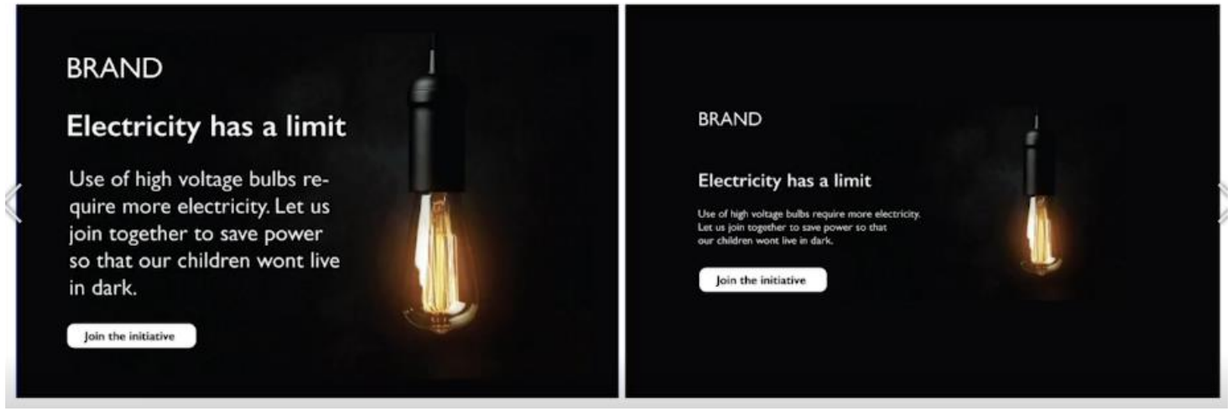




White Space

- **Grouping (Proximity)**: By placing items close together, they are perceived as related, aiding in organizing information logically. This is based on the Gestalt principles of perception, specifically proximity.
- **Readability**: More space around text and other elements makes a page easier to scan and understand. It reduces cognitive load, making interactions more intuitive.

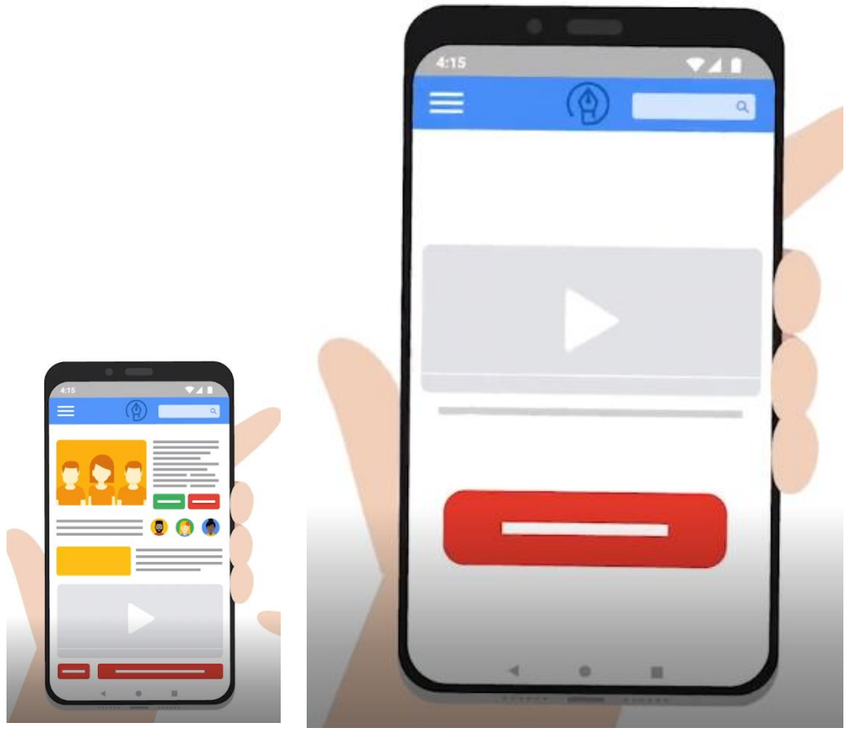




Practical Example

- Consider a webpage layout: Adding white space around a large headline can help it stand out more than if it were crammed next to other elements.
- In a menu or navigation bar, appropriate spacing between items ensures that users can easily differentiate and select the options without errors.

- **Tips for Using White Space:**
- **Balance**: Too little white space can make a design feel cluttered and overwhelming, while too much may seem empty or unfinished. Striking the right balance is key.
- **Consistency**: Apply white space uniformly to create a coherent visual experience across different parts of your design.
- **Functionality**: Use spacing not just for aesthetic appeal but to improve the functionality of your design. For instance, adequate space between buttons reduces user errors.
- White space is not just an empty area but a powerful design tool that plays a crucial role in content prioritization and user navigation. As you continue to work on your mockups, consider how the strategic use of white space can enhance the overall user experience. Good luck with your design project, and remember, sometimes less really is more!



Emphasis in UX design

- Emphasis involves drawing attention to specific elements within a design to guide user interactions. For instance, a public speaker uses vocal emphasis to highlight important points, or a musician emphasizes certain notes to enhance a performance. In visual design, emphasis helps direct the viewer's attention to areas of importance.
- **Why Use Emphasis?**
- The main goal of using emphasis is to make it easy for users to understand where to focus. Whether it’s a call to action on a web page, a key feature within an app, or important content, emphasizing correctly can significantly enhance the user experience by:
- **Guiding the User's Attention**: Emphasis helps users focus on what's important, making navigational tasks easier.
- **Improving Readability and Interaction**: Proper emphasis ensures that users can quickly find the information or controls they need.
- **Enhancing Aesthetic Appeal**: Well-placed emphasis can make a design more visually appealing and engaging.



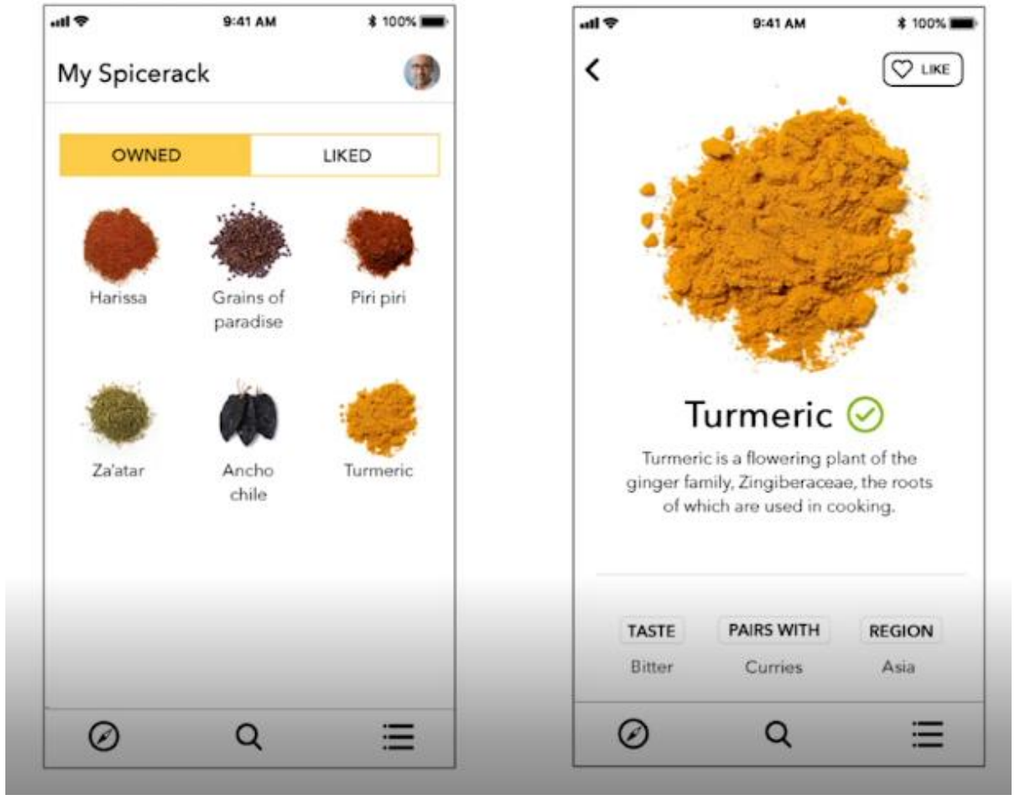
Emphasis in UX design

How to Emphasize Elements in Design

- To effectively emphasize elements, you can manipulate several visual properties:
- **Size**: Larger elements naturally draw more attention.
- **Color**: Bright or contrasting colors can make elements stand out.
- **Contrast**: Using light and dark elements effectively can highlight key features.
- **Position**: Placing important elements where users tend to look first, like the top-left corner of a screen, increases visibility.

Practical Example

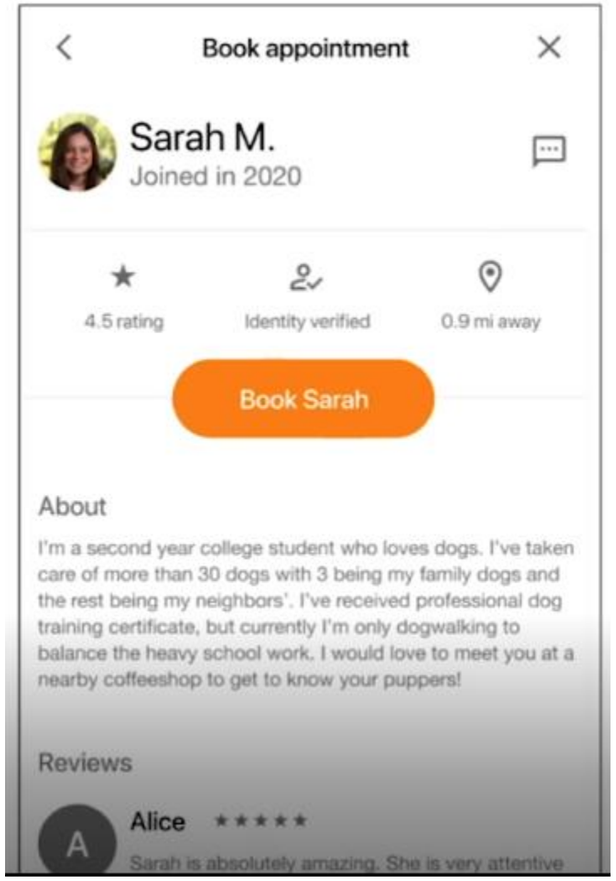
- Consider the app Zest, designed by a UX designer at Google. This app uses large, colorful images of spices to draw attention, utilizing white space and a clean typeface to keep the user focused on the main content. This is a perfect example of how visual weight and simplicity can emphasize key elements effectively.



https://webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker/

Emphasis in UX design

- **Where do I want to draw the user's attention?**
- **What are the user's goals and how can emphasis help achieve them?**
- For example, if the main action you want a user to take is to book a service, like in a dog walker app, you might use a bold color for the 'Book' button to make it stand out from less critical elements like 'About' or 'Reviews'.
- **Implementing Emphasis**
- As you develop your designs, consider how each element supports the overall user journey. Adjustments may be necessary based on user feedback or usability testing to ensure that the most important elements are appropriately emphasized.
- In summary, effective use of emphasis in UX design not only improves how users interact with your product but also ensures they have a pleasant and efficient experience. As we continue, we'll explore how to combine emphasis with other design principles like hierarchy to refine your designs further. Get ready to apply these concepts to your own projects!



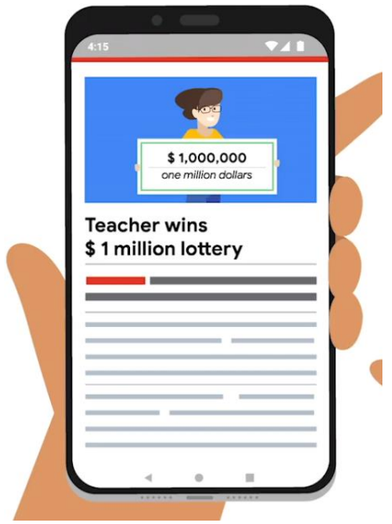
What is Hierarchy?

- Hierarchy in visual design helps order elements by their significance. It uses size, color, and placement to establish a flow that directs the user's attention to the most important information first. This principle is fundamental in ensuring that users can navigate your design intuitively.
- **How Hierarchy Differs from Emphasis**
- While emphasis focuses on making a specific element stand out, hierarchy involves arranging a group of elements in order of importance. This might mean that while one item is emphasized, other items are also structured to support the overall design narrative.
- **Examples of Hierarchy**
- **News Websites**: Headlines are often the most prominent text, followed by summaries and then the body content, using different font sizes and weights to draw attention appropriately.
- **App Interfaces**: Important buttons or actions might be larger or more colorful than less critical elements.

Hierarchy

A visual design principle that orders elements on a page and highlights them by their importance

Hierarchy refers to a group of elements that are organized in order of importance.

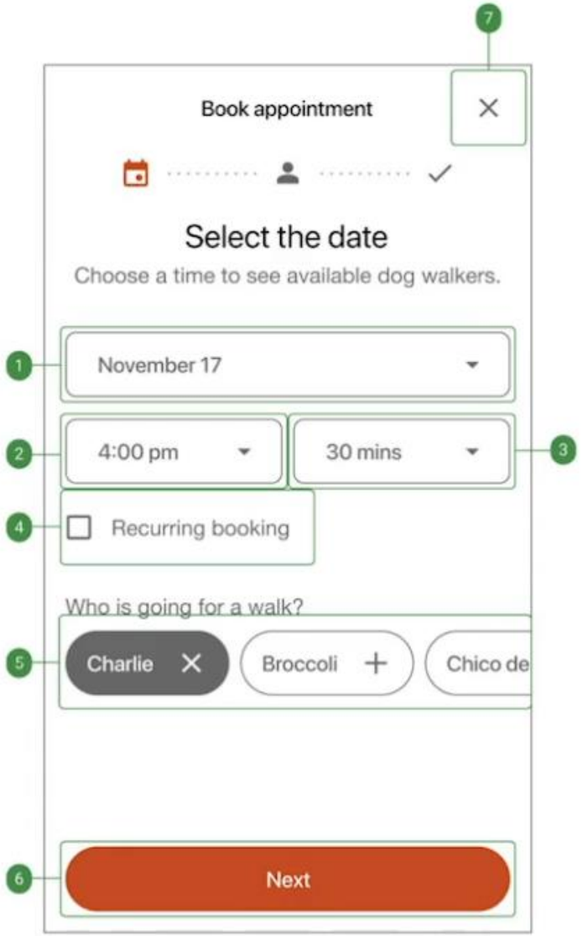


Importance of Hierarchy in UX Design

- **Guides the User**: By clearly showing where to focus first, hierarchy ensures users feel guided rather than lost.
- **Enhances Usability**: Well-implemented hierarchy makes apps and websites easier to navigate, improving overall user satisfaction.
- **Supports Content Management**: It helps manage content on a page, especially when there's a lot of information to present.

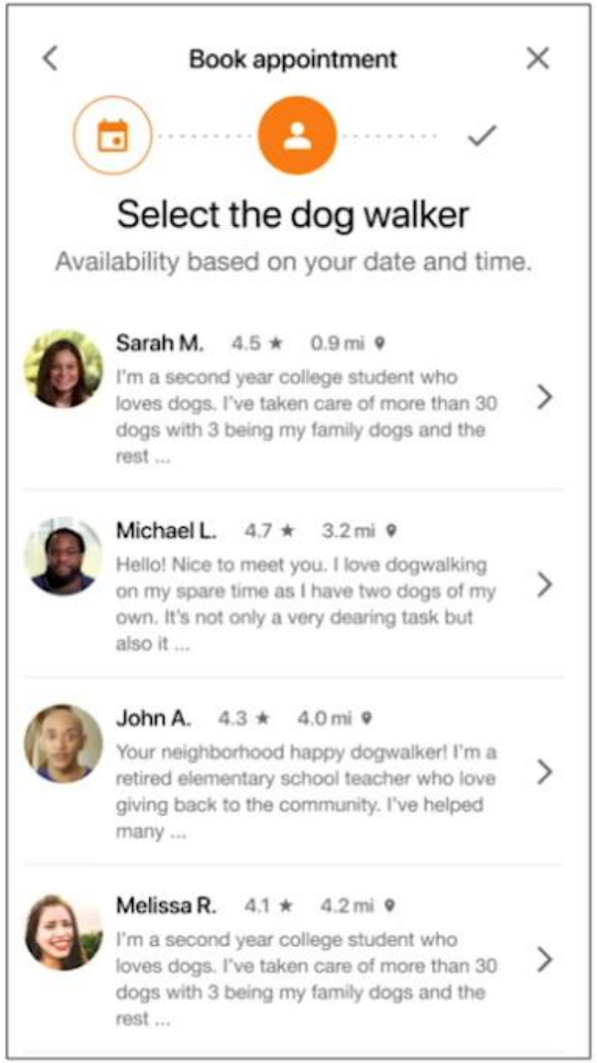
Implementing Hierarchy in Your Designs

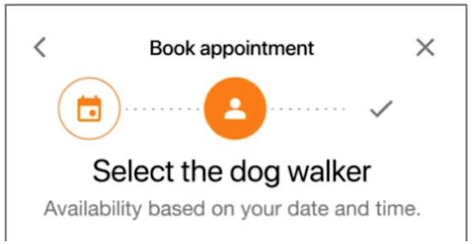
- **Size**: Larger elements are seen as more important.
- **Color**: Bright or contrasting colors catch the eye faster.
- **Contrast**: Strong contrasts between elements can help differentiate sections of content effectively.
- **Spacing**: Adequate spacing between elements can highlight their hierarchy.



Practical Application

- Consider a dog walker app. On the booking screen, you might want the 'Book Now' button to stand out as the primary action. You could use a larger size, a contrasting color, or place it centrally to ensure it catches the user's eye first. Below this, secondary options like 'More Information' could be less prominent.
- **Why We Need Hierarchy**
- Hierarchy isn't just about beauty—it's practical:
- **Focuses Attention**: It draws the user's eye to the most important information or action.
- **Organizes Information**: Helps users process information efficiently by prioritizing content.
- **Facilitates Navigation**: Makes it easier for users to find their way around an app or website, enhancing the overall user experience.

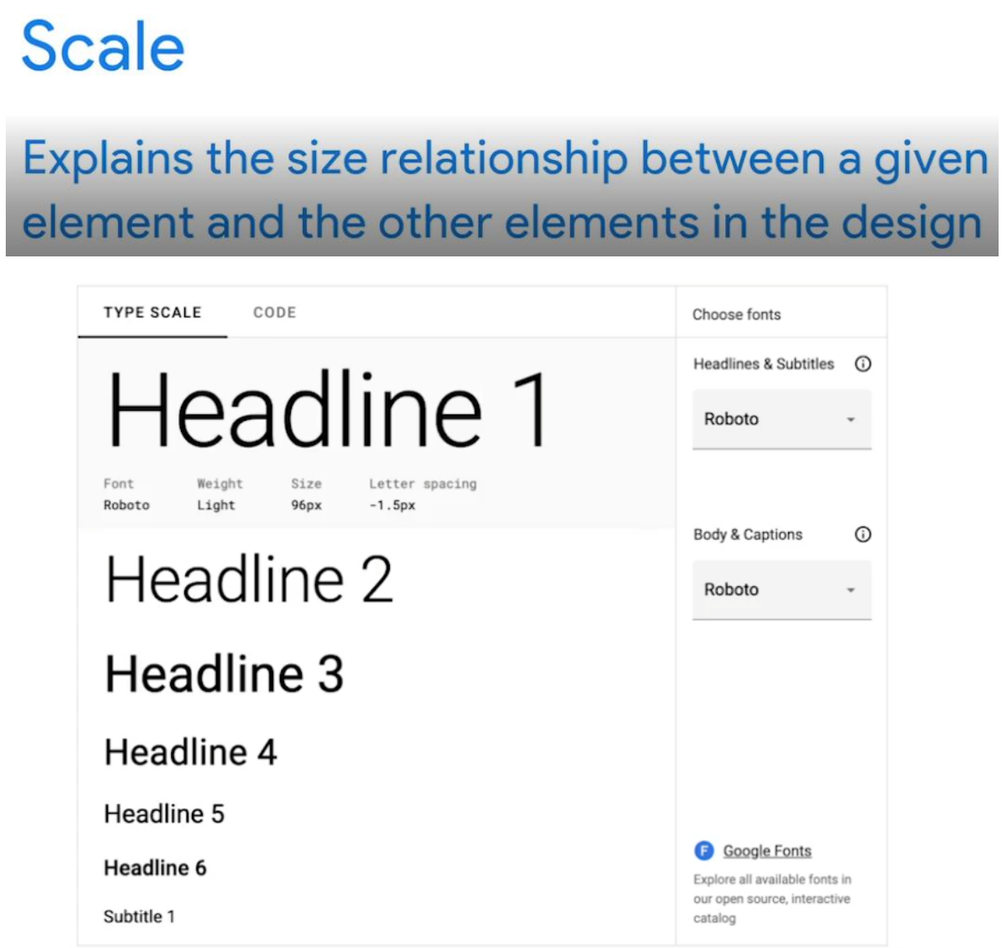




Scale and proportion in UX design

What is Scale?

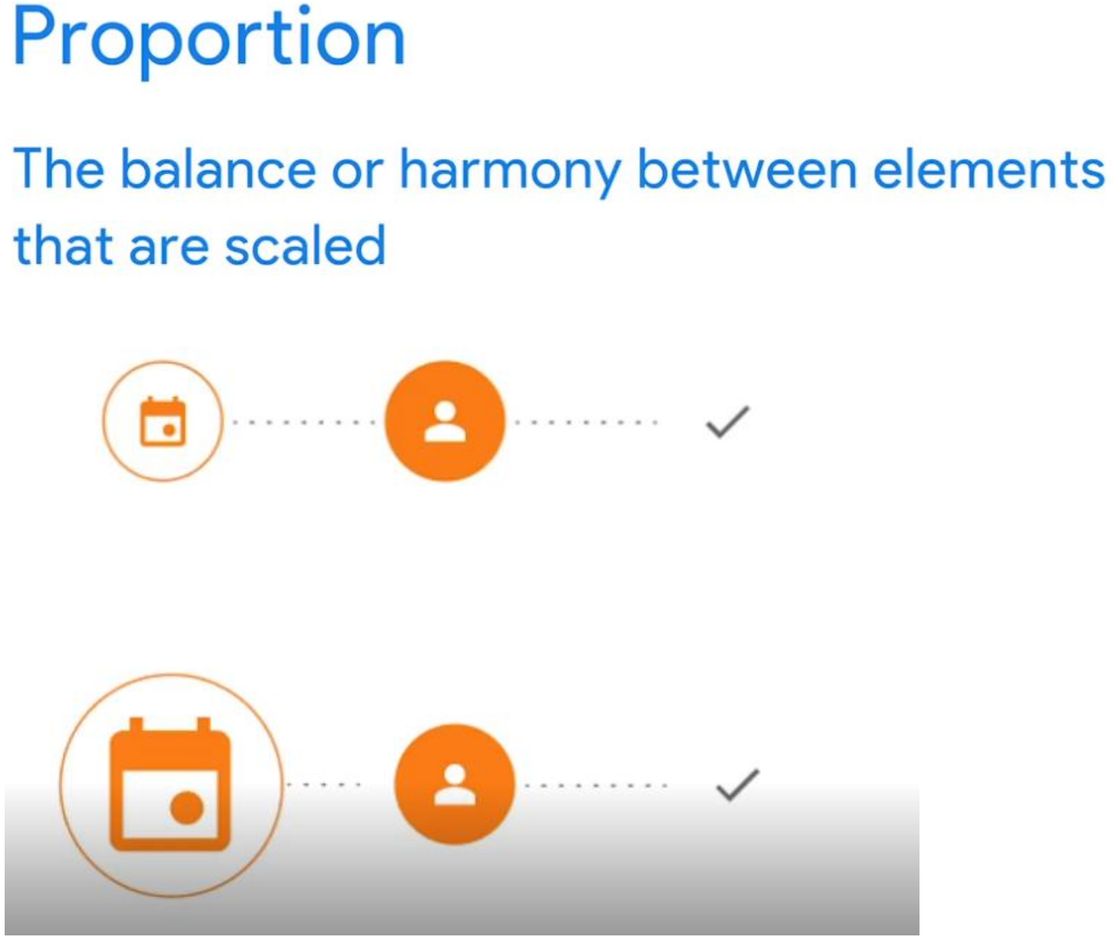
- Scale refers to the relative size of elements within a design. It's a powerful tool to create visual interest and establish focal points. For instance, scaling up a button can make it more prominent and encourage clicks.
- **Why Scale Matters in UX Design**
- **Creates Emphasis**: Larger elements naturally draw attention.
- **Establishes Importance**: Bigger elements are often perceived as more important.
- **Enhances Visual Hierarchy**: Scale can help arrange elements by importance, making the design easier to navigate.



Scale and proportion in UX design

Introducing Proportion

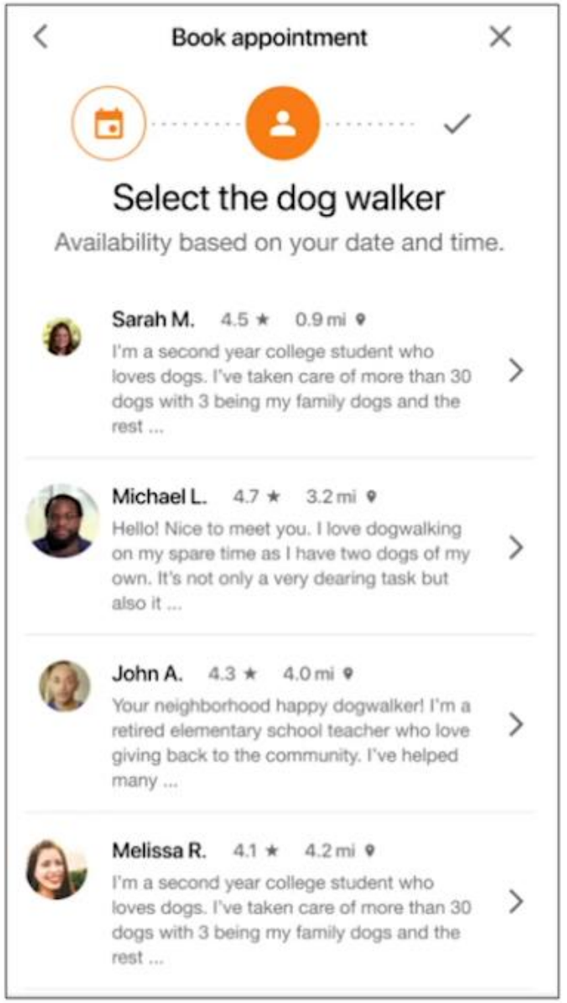
- While scale deals with size, proportion refers to the balance between these sizes. It ensures that the elements of a design feel cohesive and harmonious.
- **Why Proportion is Key**
- **Maintains Design Integrity**: Keeps the visual elements in balance, preventing the design from feeling disjointed.
- **Enhances Readability and Aesthetics**: Properly proportioned elements make a design more visually appealing and easier to understand.



Scale and proportion in UX design

- **Applying Scale and Proportion**
- When applying these principles to your mockups, consider the relationship between elements:
- Ensure that important buttons or calls-to-action are scaled larger but remain proportionate to other elements.
- Use scale to create a visual flow that guides the user through the interface naturally.

- **Example in Practice: The Dog Walker App**
- In our dog walker app, ensuring the images of the dog walkers are the same size and spaced evenly can convey equality and balance. If one image were significantly larger than the others, it would suggest greater importance, potentially skewing user perception and interaction.
- **Remembering Accessibility**
- Scale and proportion also play a critical role in accessibility. Elements need to be visible and distinguishable for all users, including those with visual impairments. Consistent and balanced elements help in creating a navigable interface for everyone.
- As we continue, keep in mind how scale and proportion not only affect the aesthetics of your design but also its functionality and user experience. Up next, we'll explore how unity and variety further enhance your design's effectiveness. Stay tuned!



Unity and variety in UX design

Unity in Design

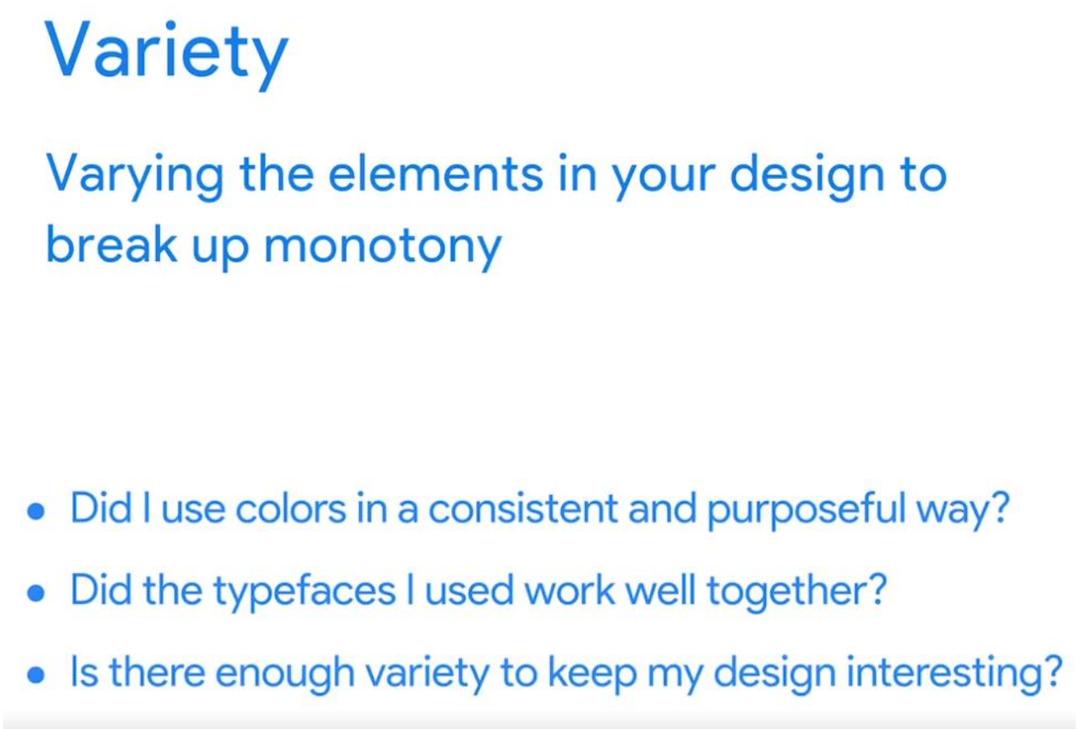
- Unity is about coherence and harmony in your design. It ensures that all design elements work together seamlessly to convey a unified message. Achieving unity involves consistent use of colors, fonts, and layouts. When elements in a design are unified, they create a clean, organized look that's pleasing and easy to understand.
- **Why Unity Matters:**
- **Visual Coherence**: Ensures all parts of the design work together to form a cohesive whole.
- **Enhanced Usability**: Makes interfaces easier to navigate by clearly showing related content through consistent design choices.

Introducing Variety

- Variety, on the other hand, involves introducing differences to break up monotony in a design. This can include varying colors, shapes, sizes, and textures to make certain elements stand out and keep the user's interest.
- **Benefits of Variety:**
- **Visual Interest**: Adds excitement and captures attention by breaking up uniformity.
- **Emphasis Creation**: Helps important elements stand out, guiding users toward key interactions.

Balancing Unity and Variety

- While unity brings harmony, too much can make a design dull. Variety spices things up but can lead to visual chaos if overdone. The key is to strike a balance:
- Use unity to create a clear, coherent base for your design.
- Employ variety to highlight important elements and keep the user engaged.



Unity and variety in UX design

Practical Application

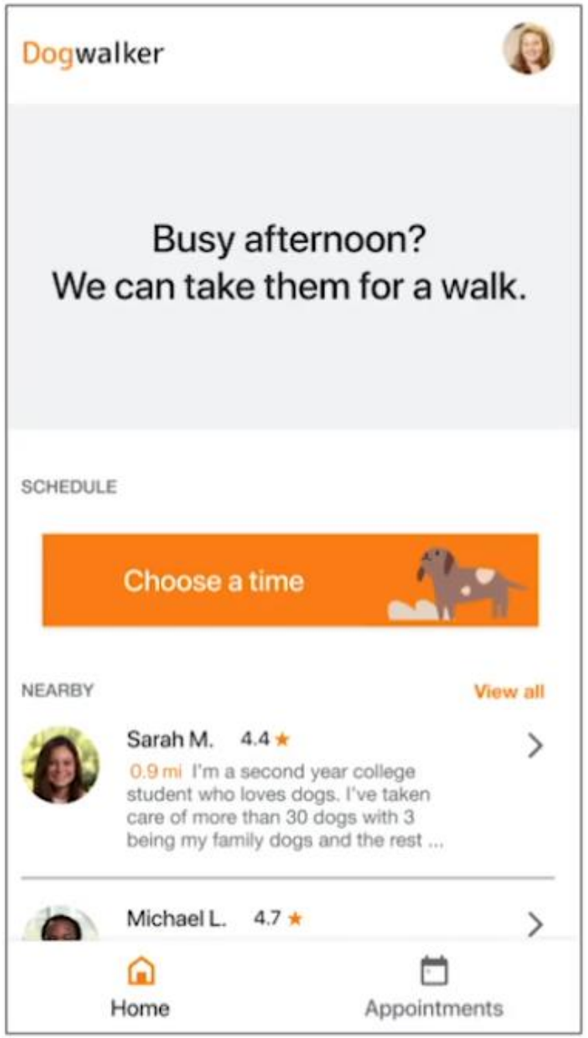
- Consider an app with a consistent color scheme and uniform typography—this is unity. Now, if you have a call-to-action button in a contrasting color, that's variety. It breaks the flow slightly to draw attention precisely where you want it.

Example in UX Design:

- Imagine a news app where most text is in black, set against a white background—this is unity. Now, a breaking news notification might appear in bold, bright colors to stand out—this is variety used effectively to grab attention.

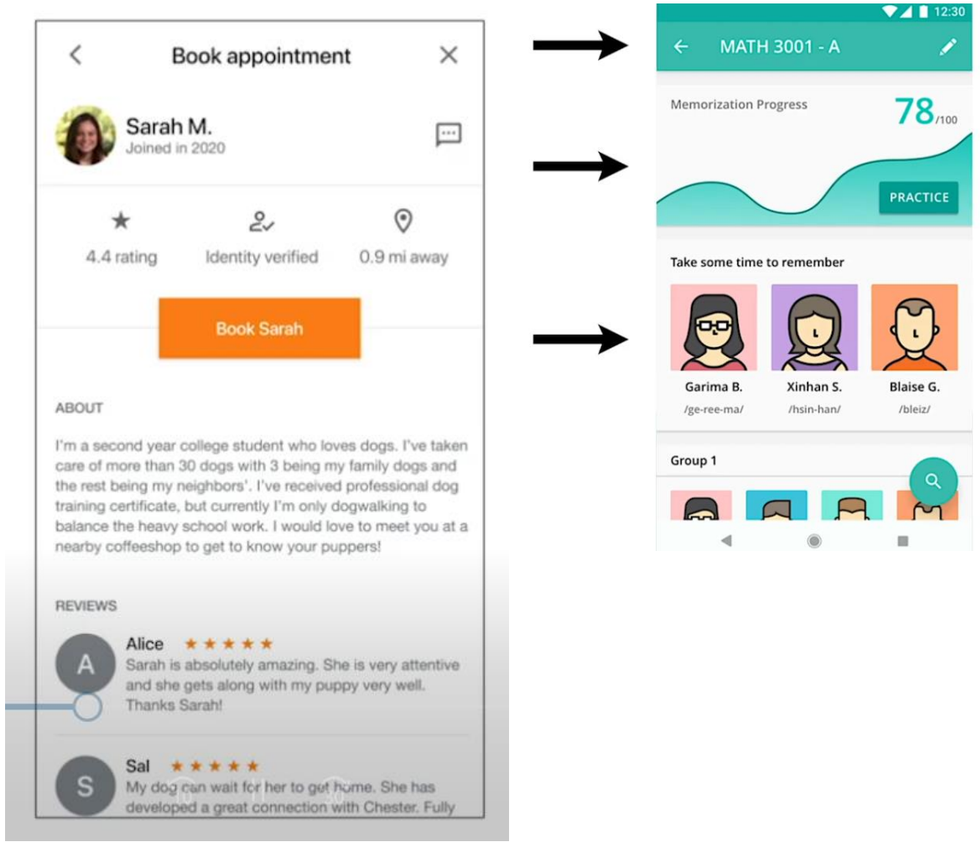
Conclusion

- As you design, constantly ask yourself:
- Is my design coherent and easy to navigate? (Unity)
- Are there elements that need more attention or differentiation? (Variety)
- Both unity and variety are vital in creating designs that are not only visually appealing but also functionally effective. By mastering these principles, you can ensure that your designs are both beautiful and practical, leading to a better user experience.



Apply Gestalt Principles to mockups

- Hi again! Today, we delve into some advanced visual design principles with a focus on Gestalt psychology. This principle is crucial in understanding how we perceive and organize visual elements in design.
- **Understanding Gestalt Principles**
- Gestalt psychology explores how people tend to organize visual elements into groups or unified wholes when certain principles are applied. These principles are essential in UX design as they help us understand the user's perspective better and design more intuitively.
- **Key Gestalt Principles:**
- **Similarity**: This principle asserts that objects that look similar are perceived as more related than objects that don't. Similarity can be achieved through color, shape, size, or texture.
- **Proximity**: Objects that are close to each other tend to be viewed as a group. Proximity simplifies the complex images we see by grouping elements into a cohesive whole.
- **Common Region**: Elements tend to be perceived as part of a group if they are located within the same closed region. This principle works closely with proximity but focuses more on using boundaries to associate elements.



Apply Gestalt Principles to mockups

Application in UX Design

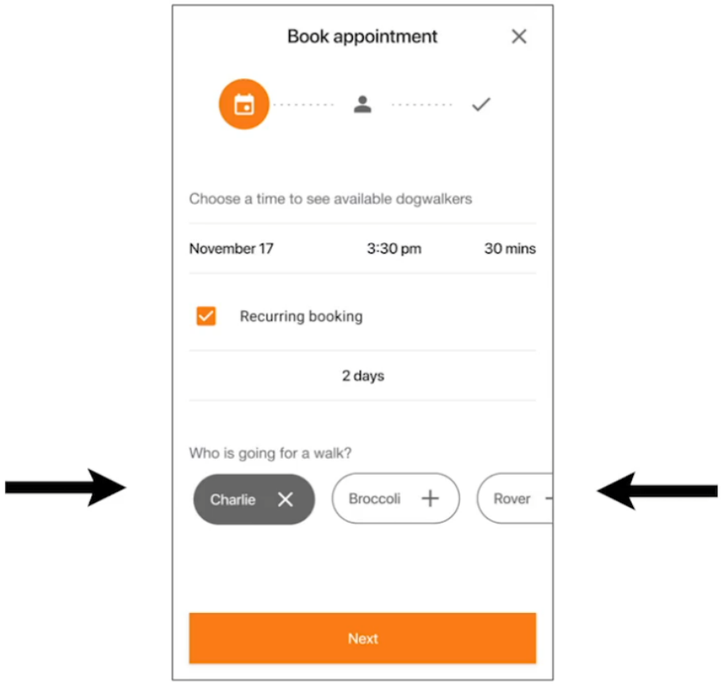
- **Similarity**: Use consistent design elements like color or font style to link similar actions c content.
- **Proximity**: Group related buttons or information closely together to reinforce their relationship.
- **Common Region**: Use boxes or different background colors to visually group related items c separate distinct sections of content.

Importance of Gestalt Principles in UX:

- **Improves User Experience**: By organizing content in a way that's in line with huma psychological principles, designs become more intuitive and easier to navigate.
- **Aids Visual Organization**: Helps designers create balanced, organized layouts tha communicate more effectively.
- **Enhances Aesthetics**: Proper application of Gestalt principles not only makes design functional but also visually appealing.

Practical Tips:

- **Review Designs with Gestalt in Mind**: Regularly step back and review your designs to ensur elements are grouped logically.
- **Test Your Designs**: Use Gestalt principles to test whether users can understand and interact with your design as intended.
- In summary, integrating Gestalt principles into your design process can dramatically improve how users perceive and interact with your product. By aligning your design strategy with the way users naturally process visual information, you can create more effective, user-friendly interfaces.



pause and review your work

1. Detail View

Focus on the Finer Elements: Check the consistency of typography, colors, and iconography across all your mockups.

Example: In the dog walker app, ensure that the orange color used for actions is consistent across all elements.

2. Page-Level View

Balance and Unity: Assess whether all elements on each page are well-balanced and unified.

Check for Visual Hierarchy: Ensure the layout leads the viewer naturally through the content.

3. Function-Level View

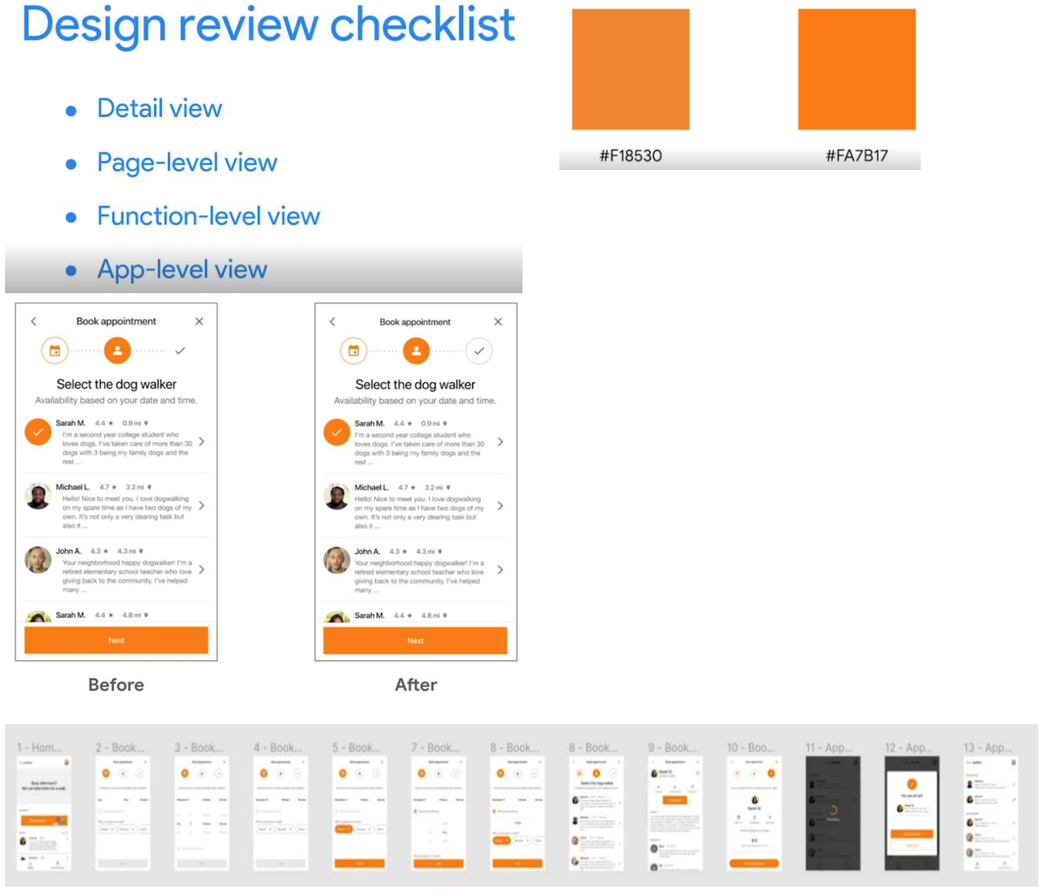
Operational Integrity: Verify that all interactive elements function as intended.

Navigation Review: Make sure that navigation elements like buttons and links are correctly placed and functioning.

4. App-Level View

Overall Cohesion: Zoom out to see multiple pages at once to check for overall visual and functional consistency.

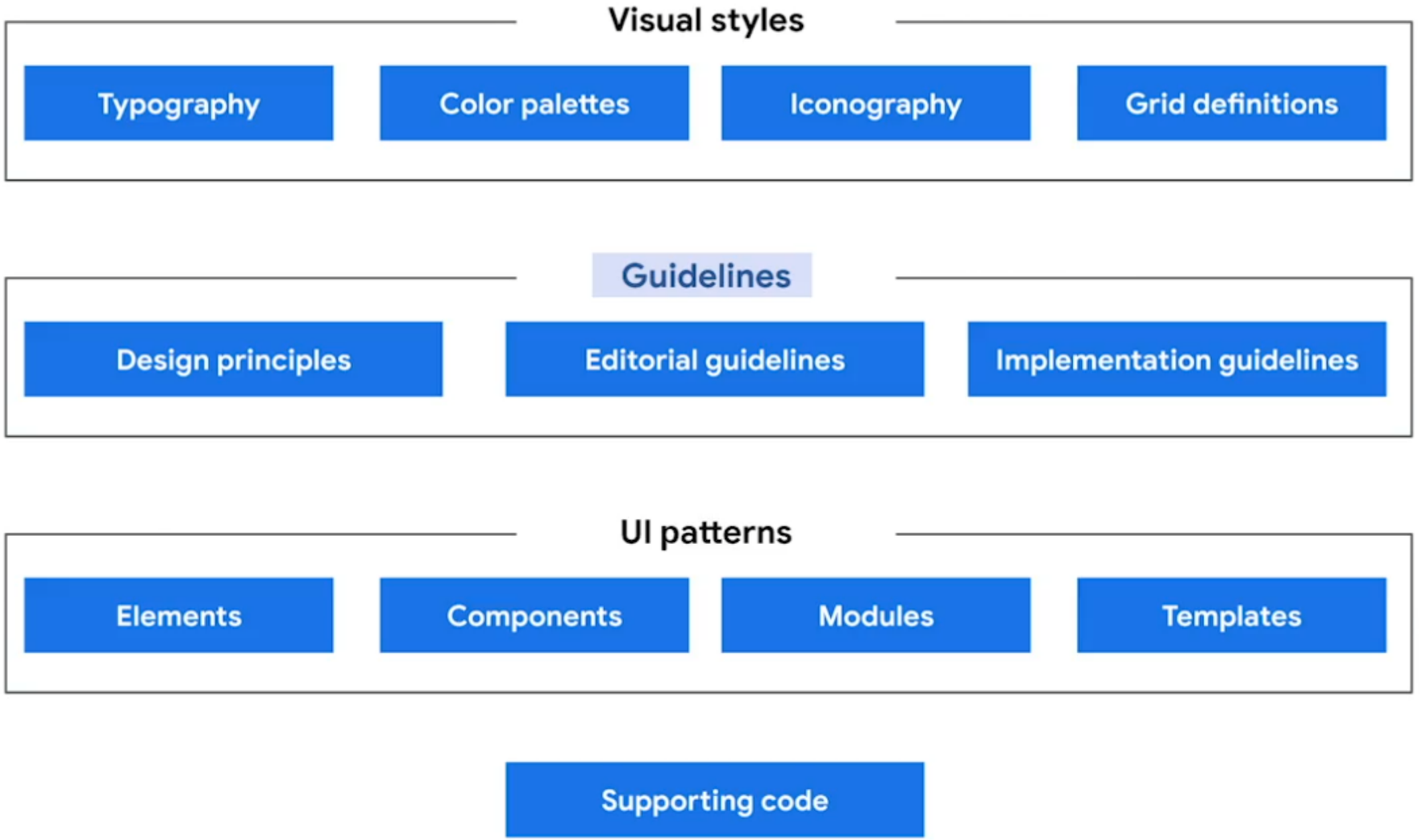
Consistency Across Screens: Ensure elements that appear on multiple screens (like navigation bars) are consistently positioned and styled.



Wrap-up Applying visual design principles to mockups

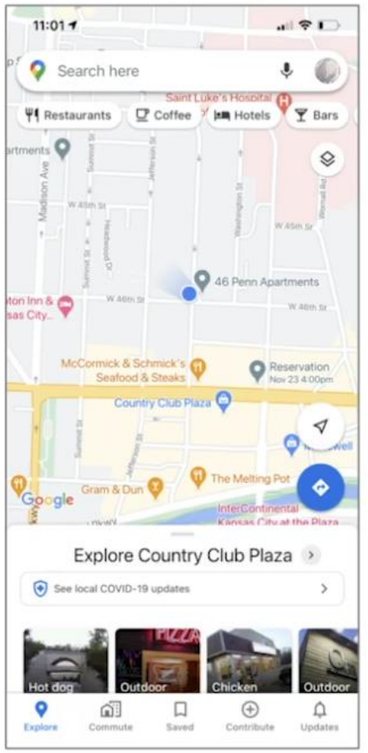
- **Emphasis**: You've understood how to draw attention to the most important elements of your design, helping users navigate your mockup effectively.
- **Hierarchy**: This taught you to arrange elements by their level of importance, guiding the user's journey through your product.
- **Scale and Proportion**: These principles help you manage the visual impact of elements relative to each other, ensuring that everything is harmoniously sized and appropriately emphasized.
- **Unity and Variety**: You've learned to balance these aspects to keep the user's interest while maintaining a cohesive design.
- **Gestalt Principles**: The exploration of similarity, proximity, and common region helped you understand how users perceive and organize visual information.
- **Review Techniques**: Finally, strategies for reviewing your work ensure that every element of your mockup is purposeful and polished.

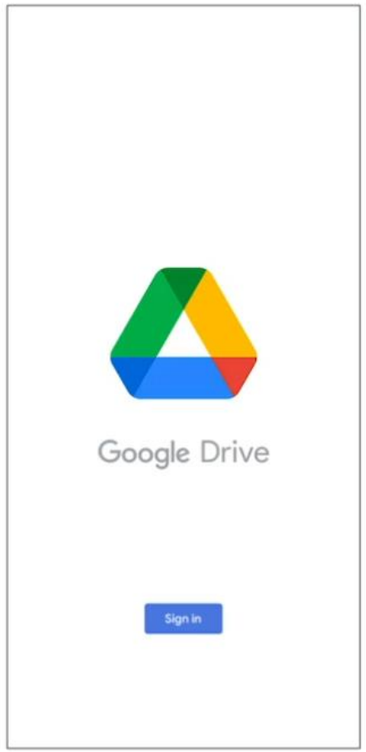
Design Systems



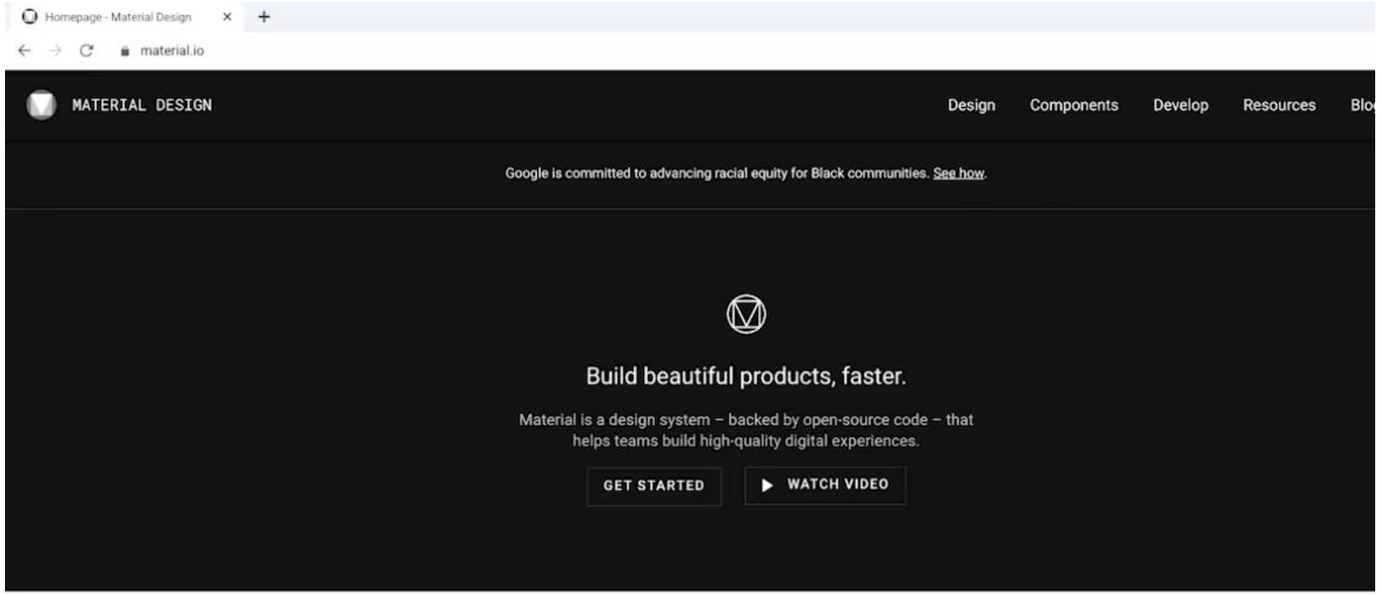
benefits of design systems

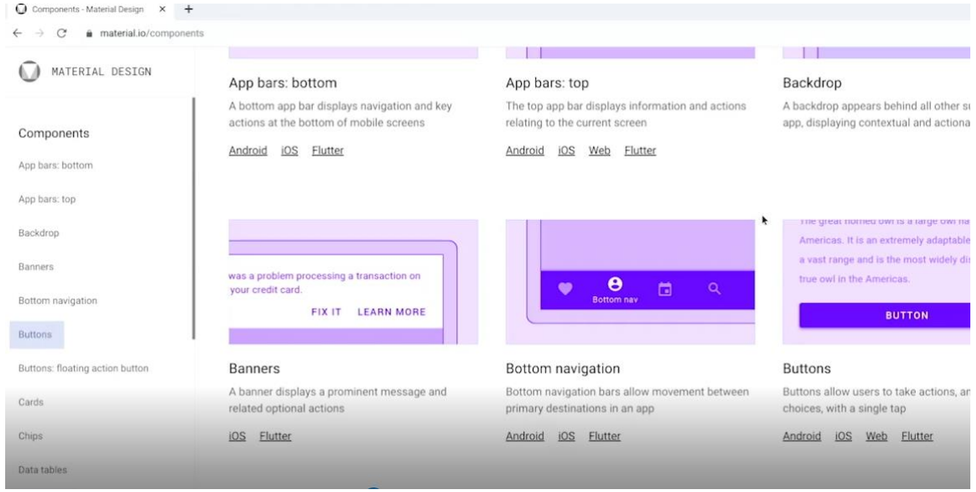
- **Consistency**: Ensures that designers adhere to a set style, reducing deviations that could affect user experience and brand identity.
- **Brand Identity**: Helps maintain a coherent visual and functional identity across all of a company's products, making them immediately recognizable to users.
- **Scalability**: Makes it easier to manage design at scale, particularly useful in growing companies where new features and products are continuously developed.
- **Efficiency**: Saves time and resources by standardizing design elements, which speeds up the design process and reduces the need for frequent clarifications.
- **Collaboration**: Facilitates better teamwork between designers and developers by providing a common language and clear expectations, streamlining the development process.

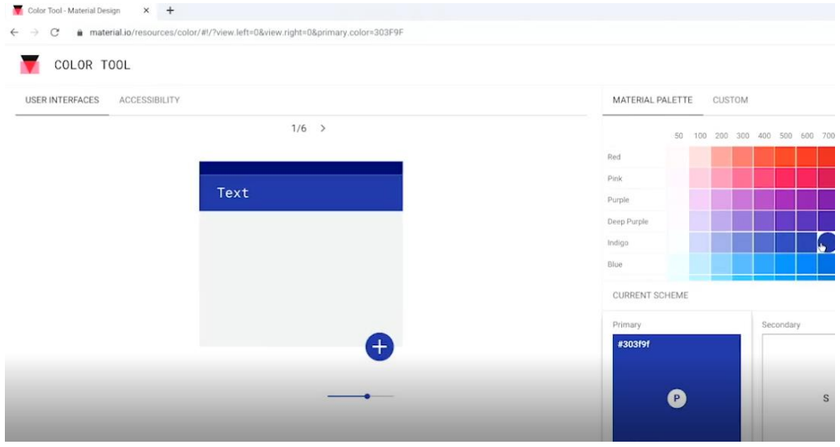


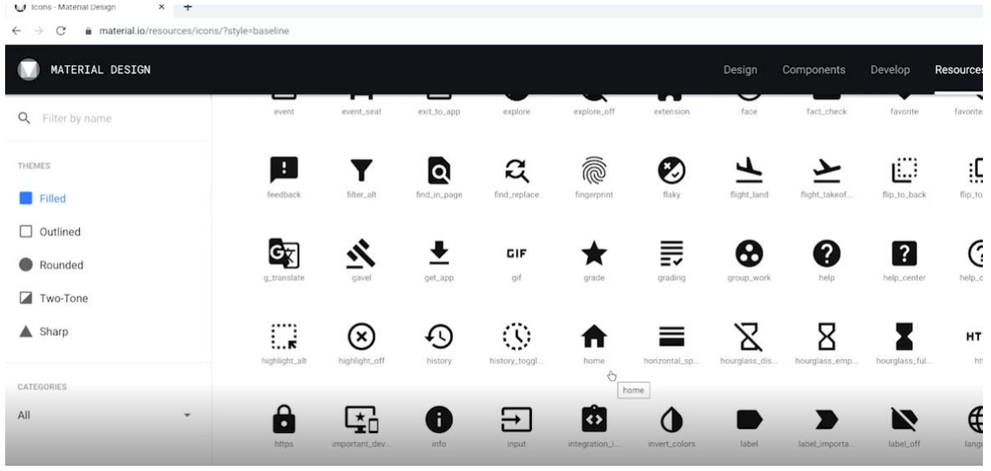


Google's design system Material Design

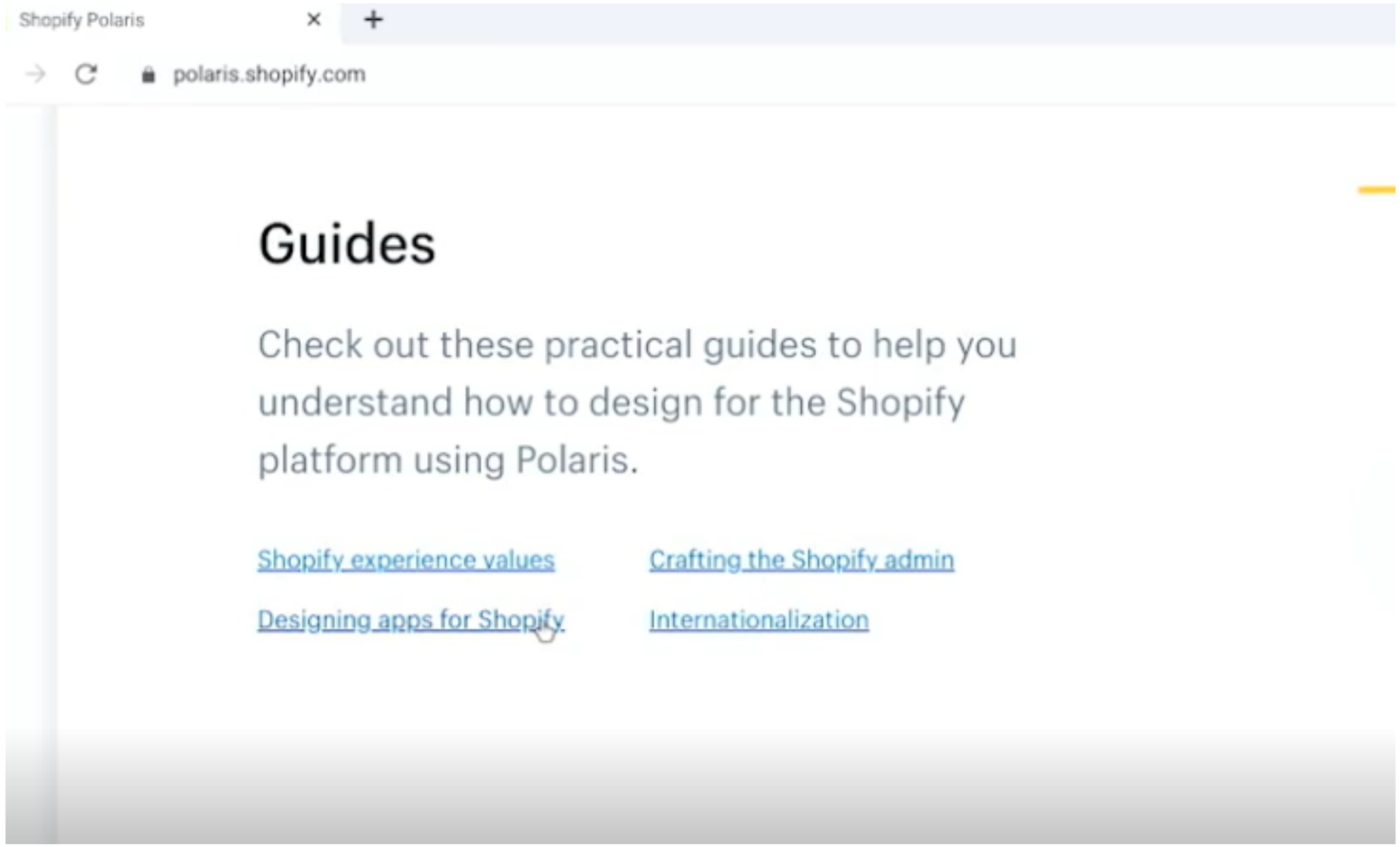






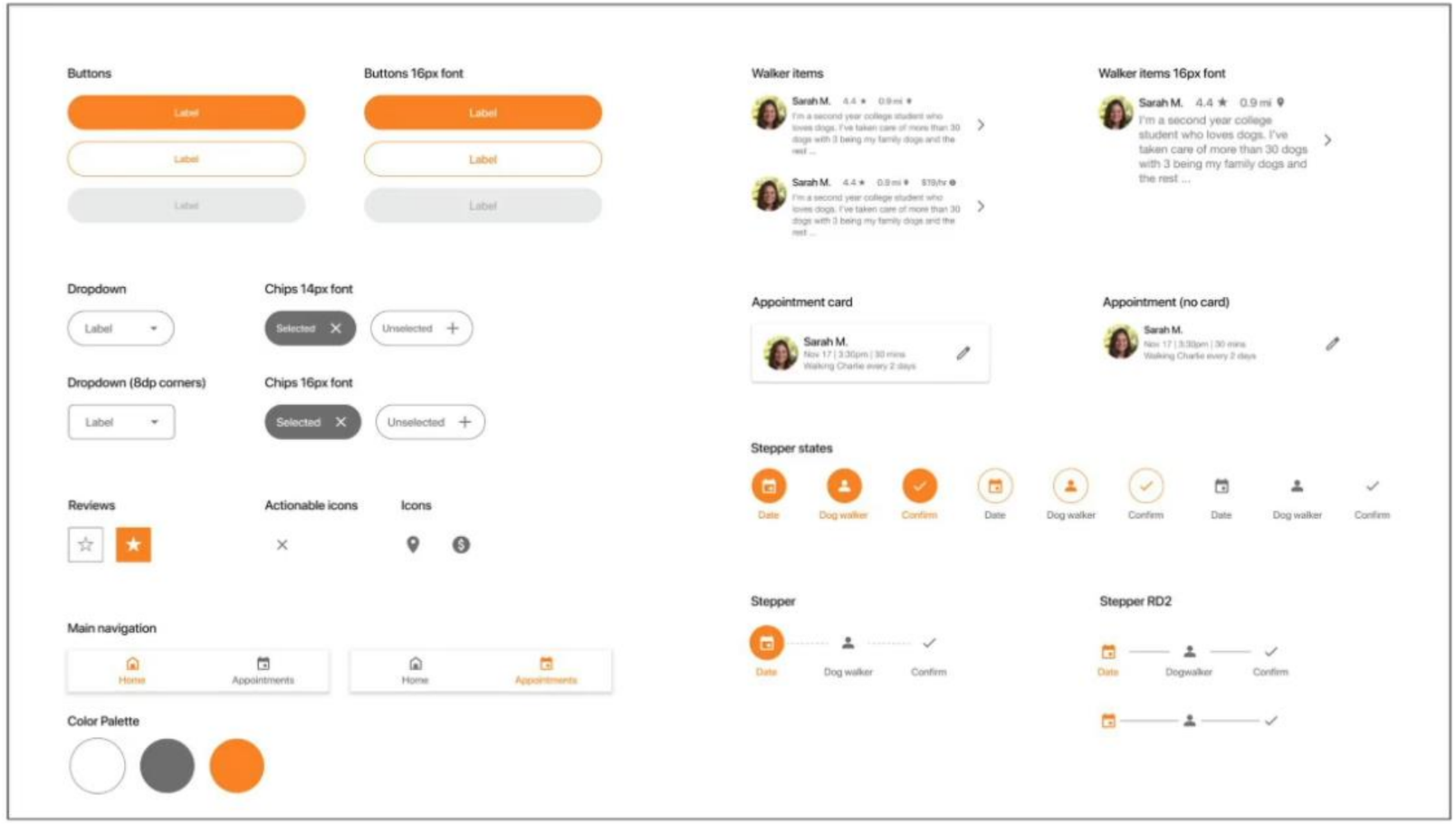


Shopify's design system Polaris

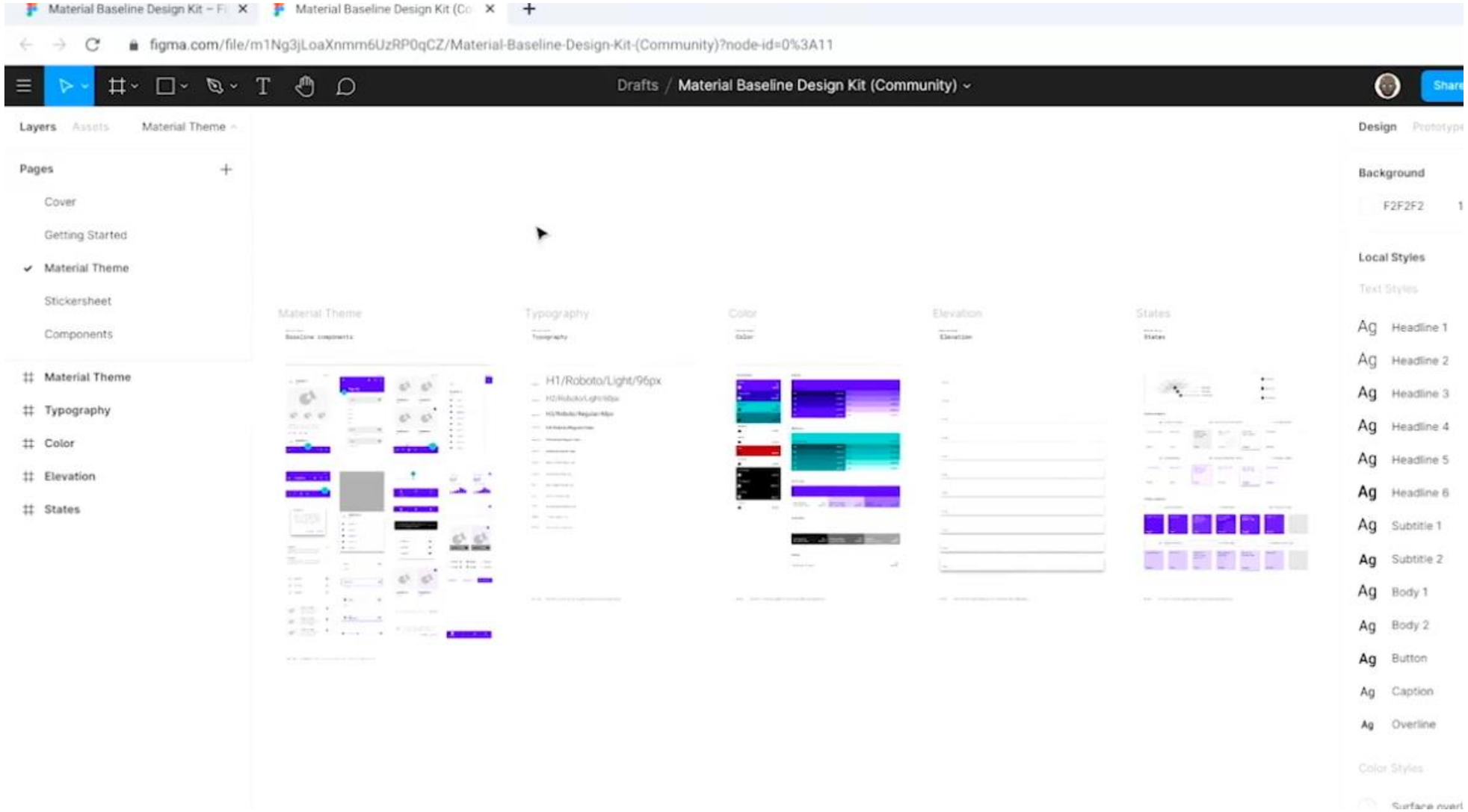


Create a sticker sheet in Figma

- Sticker sheets serve as a handy reference for designers to maintain visual and functional harmony across a product, helping to streamline the design process and reduce inconsistencies.



Use a design system library in Figma



Give and receive feedback as a UX designer

Tips for giving feedback

- Adjust for each situation
- Have a reason to support your feedback
- Describe problems with the design, not offer solutions



"I don't like the color you chose"



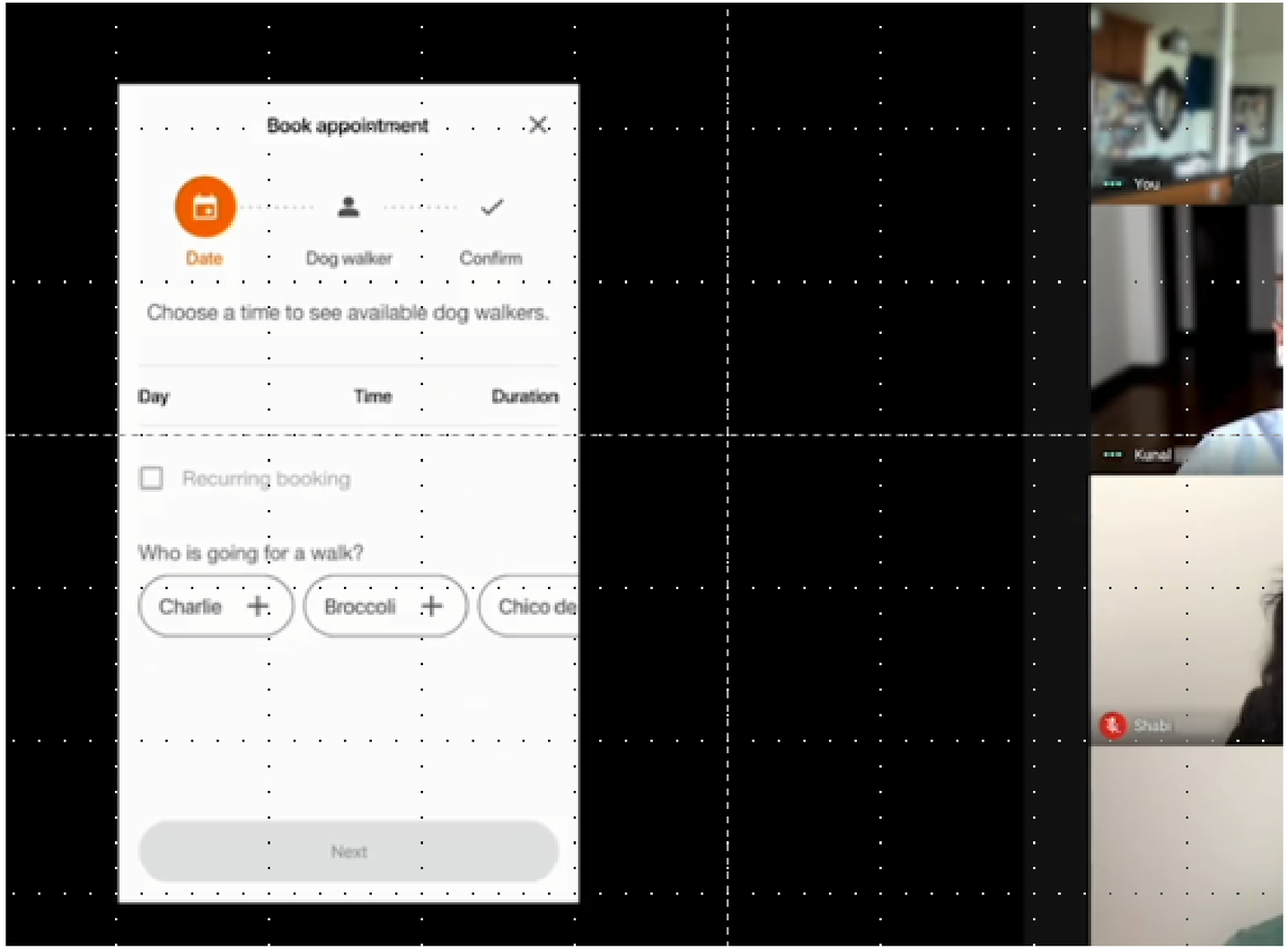
"I don't like the color you chose because it's not accessible"

The basics of design critique sessions

Example of a structure that a design critique session might follow

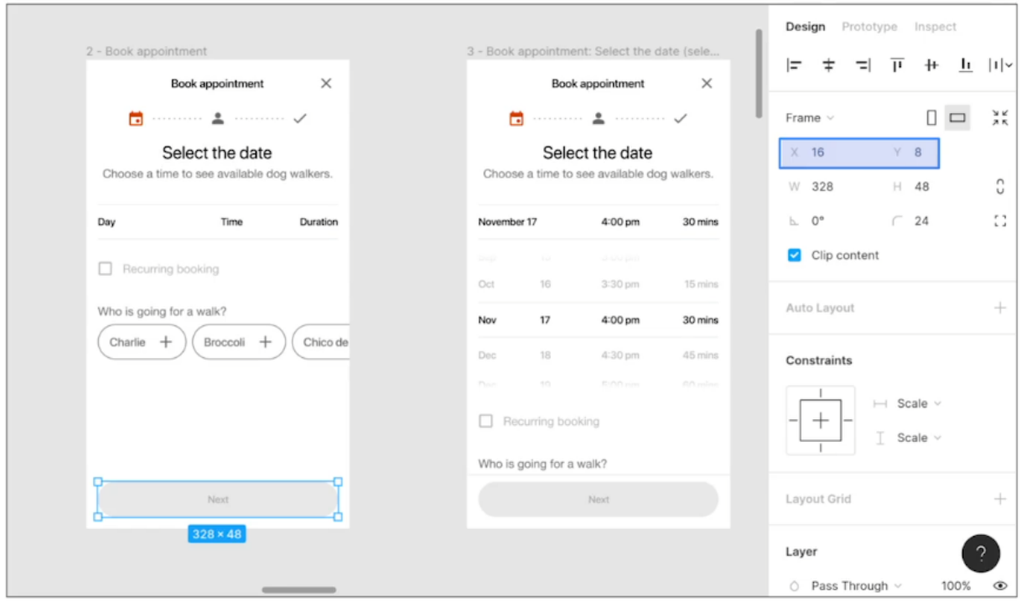
- The facilitator provides an overview of the design critique session and defines the objectives, or the goals of the design critique.
- The presenter shares their design work.
- Reviewers take turns explaining their feedback.
- Facilitator wraps up the crit session.

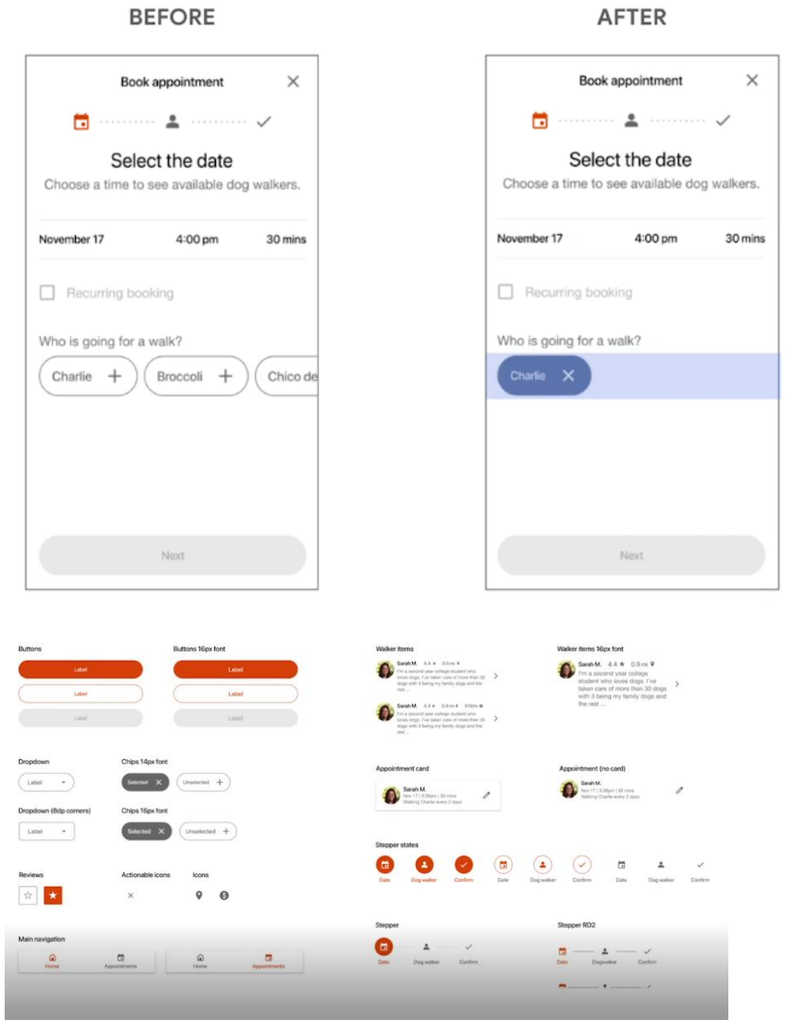
critique sessions



critique sessions

Feedback from design critique session	Action Item
Simplify date, dog walker, and confirm icons across the top of the screen	Iterate on icon design across the top of the screen Follow-up question for Shabi: Simplifying the colors of the logos or the text labels beneath the logos





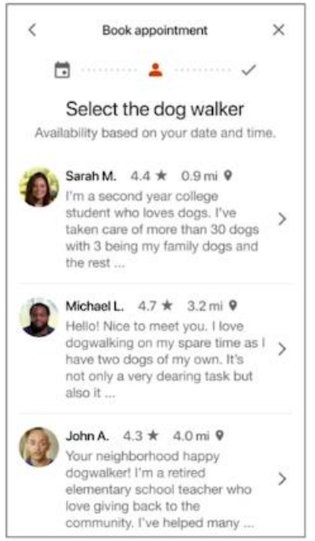
- Introduction to high-fidelity prototypes

- The process involves refining visual design elements from your mockups, such as color, images, icons, and typography, ensuring they are interactive and accurately represent the final product. You'll also need to finalize navigation and user flow, ensuring users can easily move between screens and that the user journey is intuitive and enjoyable. Additionally, high-fidelity prototypes require detailed, realistic content like actual names and images rather than placeholders to simulate a real app experience more effectively.
- Interactivity is also a crucial aspect, involving connecting each screen using the refined high-fidelity designs, creating hotspots for user interactions, and establishing connections and destinations within the prototype tool, like Figma. This ensures the prototype functions correctly and offers a realistic user interaction experience. This part of the course will further delve into making your prototype interactive, focusing on gestures and motion to bring your design to life

Low-fidelity prototypes



High-fidelity prototypes



Create a high-fidelity prototype in Figma

Here's a breakdown of each step involved in creating a high-fidelity prototype in Figma:

Step 1: Lay Out the Mockups

Start by creating a new page in your Figma file where you've been working on your wireframes and mockups. Copy and paste your mockups into this high-fidelity prototype page. Arrange these screens in the order that a user would naturally progress through your app. This sequential layout should start with the home screen and include subsequent stages such as selecting options and confirming actions. It's crucial that the screens are laid out in a way that mirrors the intended user flow, providing a logical and intuitive navigation path for users.

Step 2: Connect the Screens

Switch to prototype mode in Figma, which allows you to create interactive links between your screens. Begin by selecting an element on your starting screen that the user will interact with, such as a button or link. This element becomes your hotspot. Click on the prototype node (indicated by a blue circle on the element) and drag a connection arrow from this node to the destination screen, which is the next screen in the user journey. Make sure each connection accurately represents the user's next logical step within the app.

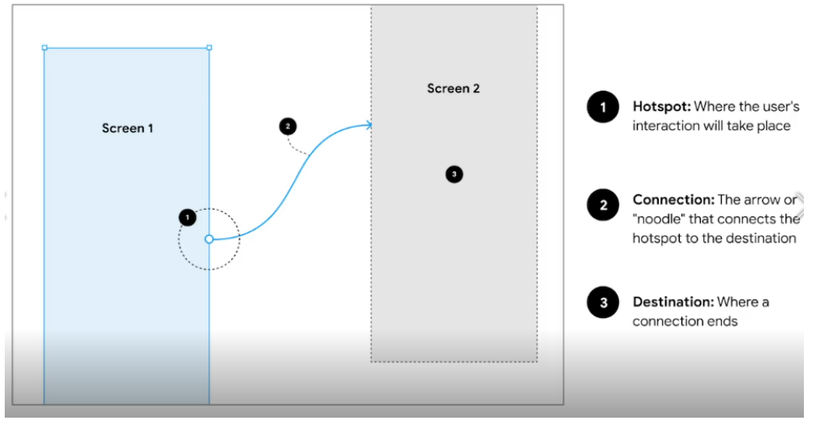
Additional Guidance:

•**Prototyping Mode:** Ensure you're in prototype mode, not design mode, to access the interactive linking features. You can switch modes using the options at the top of the right side panel in Figma.

•**Node and Connection:** The blue circle that appears on your selectable elements in prototype mode is where you create your connections. Drag from here to the target frame to define the user flow.

•**User Flow Consideration:** Before connecting the screens, ensure that the order of screens reflects the user's journey from start to finish. This setup is crucial for simulating a realistic interaction experience.

By following these steps, you lay the groundwork for a prototype that not only looks like the final product but behaves like it too, providing a valuable tool for user testing and development guidance. Once you have laid out the mockups and connected the screens as described, you can proceed with adding interactive details, animations, and finalizing your prototype, which will be covered in subsequent steps.



Gestures and motion in UX design.

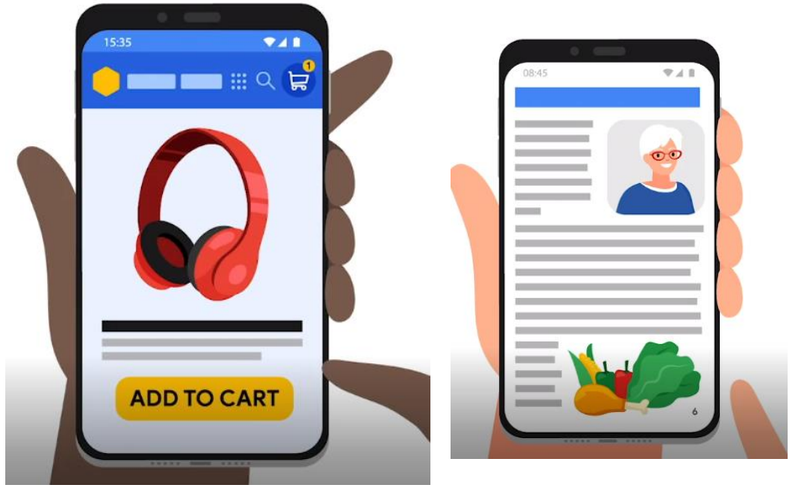
- First, let's define gestures. A gesture is an interaction method between the user and their device through touch. Common gestures include tapping, scrolling, swiping, and zooming. These actions allow users to interact directly with the information on their devices.
- Now, onto motion. Motion uses animations to automate static design elements, focusing the user's attention and enhancing storytelling within the application. Motion helps clarify subtle changes on the screen, making transitions and state changes noticeable and meaningful. For example, when you add an item to a shopping cart on a mobile app, tapping the button might trigger an animation of the cart icon. This animation draws your attention and confirms that your action has been successful. Here, the tap is the gesture, and the resulting animation represents motion.
- Another common gesture is swiping, like when you turn a page in an e-book app. The swipe is the gesture, and the page-turning animation is the motion. Both gestures and motion significantly enrich the user experience by making interactions feel more natural and responsive.

Gesture

Any method of interaction a user has with information on their device using touch

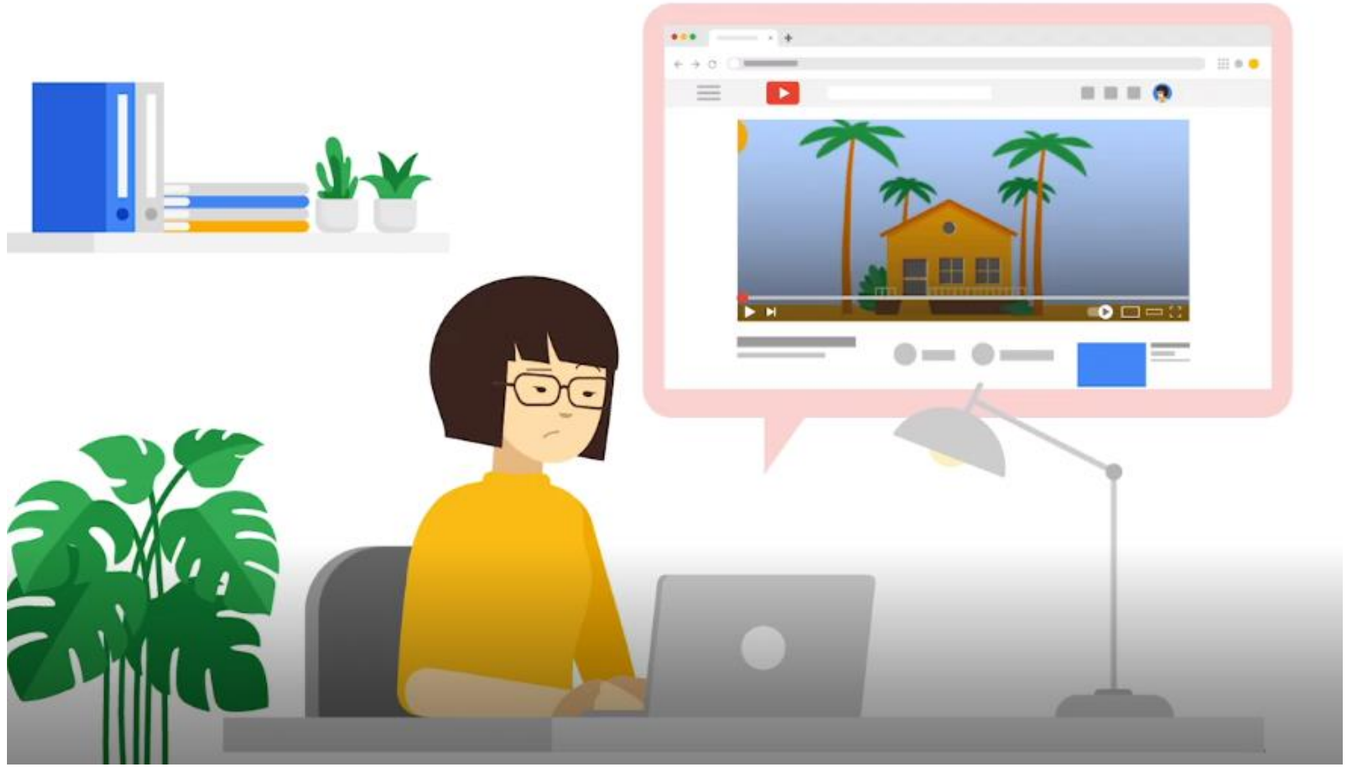
Motion

A way to animate static design elements to focus the user's attention and tell stories



Add gestures and motion in Figma

Accessibility considerations for gestures and motion



Accessibility considerations

- Provide alternative options to using gestures
- Think critically about the speed and duration of motion in your designs
- Give users the ability to turn off a motion



Accessibility considerations

"Throughout the entire product development process, we're continually trying to understand and address the needs of people with disabilities."

"Focusing on accessibility and practicing a more inclusive design practice is just plain good design."

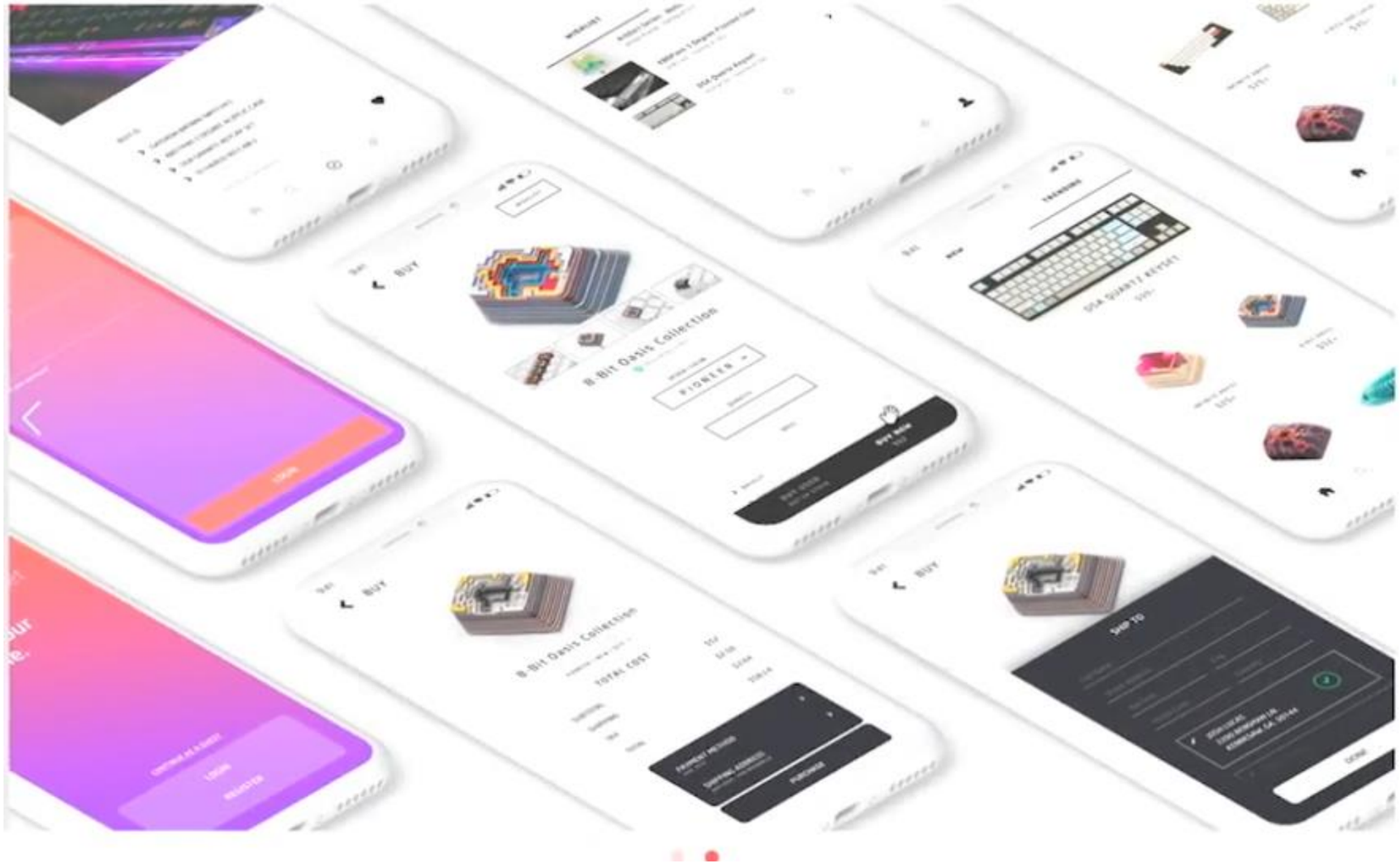
Prototype interactions

Conduct a usability study

Usability study

A research method that assesses how easy it is for participants to complete core tasks in a product

Create a case study for your portfolio project



Workshop